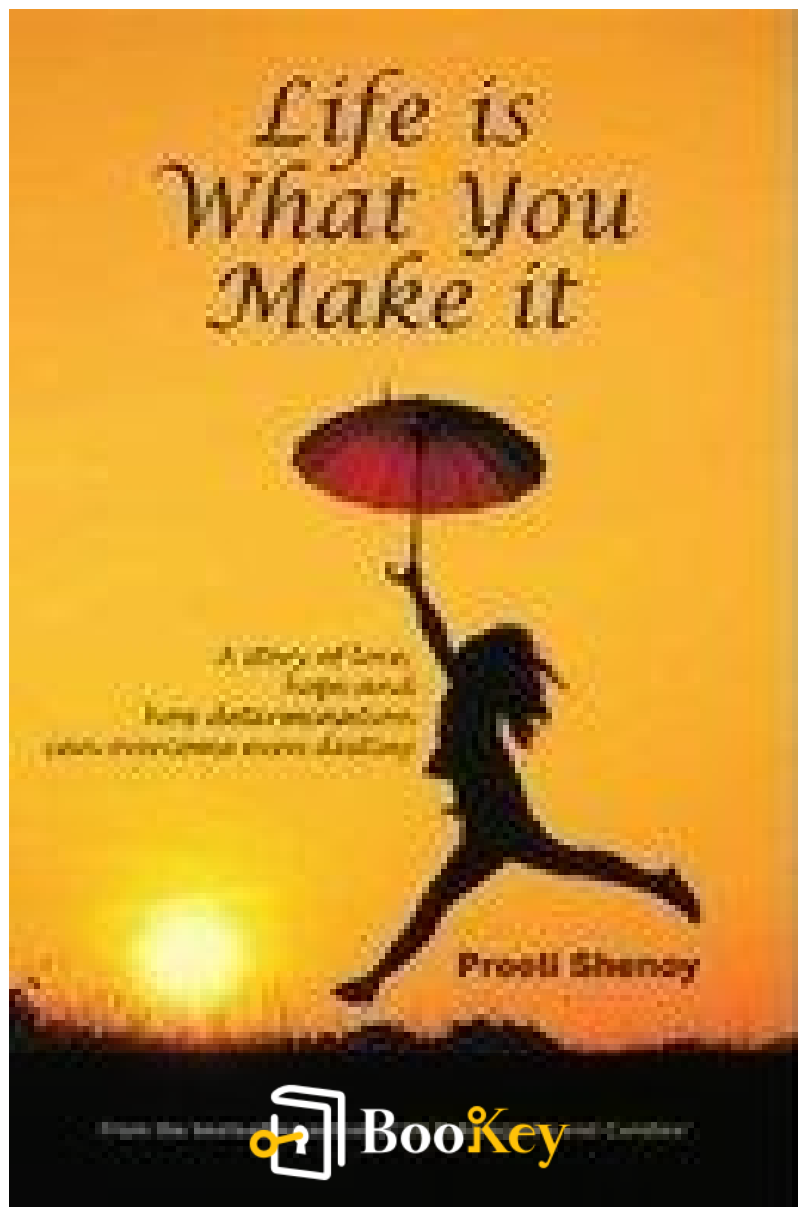


Life is What You Make It PDF

Preeti Shenoy



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Embracing Choices for a Fulfilling Life Journey.

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About the book

"Life is What You Make It" by Preeti Shenoy is an inspiring and poignant exploration of the intricacies of life, choices, and the power of resilience. The story revolves around the life of Ankita Sharma, a young woman navigating the challenges of love, mental health, and societal expectations while discovering her true self along the way. Shenoy beautifully captures the essence of personal struggles and triumphs, illustrating how our decisions shape our destinies. With its relatable characters and heartfelt narrative, this novel invites readers to reflect on their own lives, encouraging them to embrace the notion that despite life's unpredictability, it is ultimately up to each individual to craft their own destiny. Immerse yourself in this compelling tale that promises to inspire hope and ignite a passion for self-discovery.

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About the author

Preeti Shenoy is a renowned Indian author and motivational speaker, celebrated for her engaging storytelling and ability to connect with readers through relatable themes of love, relationships, and personal growth. With a background in commerce and an extensive career in the corporate world, Shenoy transitioned to writing and quickly gained popularity with her debut novel, "34 Bubblegums and Candies." Her work often draws upon her rich life experiences, infusing her narratives with emotional depth and insight. Over the years, she has published several bestsellers, earning accolades for her unique voice and inspiring messages that resonate with diverse audiences.

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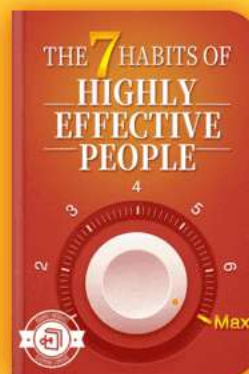
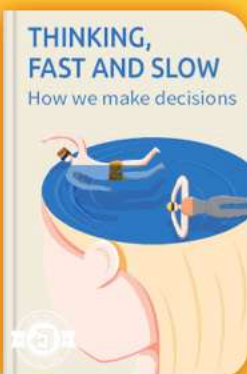


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Chapter 1 Summary : A new world



Summary of Chapter 1: A New World

Independence and Growth: Represents Ankita's transition to adulthood.

Friendship and Longing: Highlights her bond with Vaibhav during transitions.

Gender Dynamics: Explores the female-dominated environment's impact on her perspectives.

Parental Control: Reflects cultural expectations on young women through Ankita's struggles with her parents' decisions.

Summary of Chapter 1: A New World

This chapter introduces us to Ankita, a bright young woman excited about starting her college journey at St. Agnes in Cochin. Despite her enthusiasm, she feels a pang of disappointment about not being able to join her friend Vaibhav at IIT-D in Delhi, as her strict parents have restricted her choice of college. Their decision dampens her hopes of

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spending more time with him and exploring a new city together.

Ankita's letters to Vaibhav reveal her longing for friendship and the joys of college life. She reminisces about their school days and expresses her thrill about entering a new educational phase, feeling an exhilarating mix of freedom and anxiety. She describes her campus in vivid detail, highlighting the impressive architecture, the inviting library, and the vibrant atmosphere filled with fellow female students—a stark contrast to her previous co-educational experiences.

As she steps into this new world, Ankita is met with a wave of mixed emotions: excitement about newfound independence and the daunting realization of adult responsibilities. With the warm welcome from Sister Evangeline, the college's principal, she starts to feel a sense of pride in being part of this all-girls institution and looks forward to the classes and friendships that await her.

Key Themes and Character Development

-

Independence and Growth:

Ankita's transition from school to college symbolizes her

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emerging adulthood.

-

Friendship and Longing:

Her close bond with Vaibhav highlights the importance of friendship during life's transitions.

-

Gender Dynamics:

The college setting exposes her to a female-dominated environment, challenging her previous experiences and perspectives.

-

Parental Control:

Ankita's struggle with her parents' decisions reflects the cultural expectations and limitations placed on young women.

Overall, the chapter effectively sets the stage for Ankita's journey, combining elements of personal struggle, the promise of exploration, and the excitement of new beginnings.

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Critical Thinking

Key Point:Independence and Growth

Critical Interpretation:Ankita's transition to college reflects the complexities of gaining independence while facing parental restrictions.

Key Point:The Impact of Parental Control

Critical Interpretation:The influence of Ankita's parents restricts her freedom, initiating an internal conflict about her identity.

Key Point:Friendship and Longing

Critical Interpretation:Ankita's letters convey a deep yearning for connection, emphasizing how vital friendships are during life transitions.

Key Point:Gender Dynamics

Critical Interpretation:The female-centric environment offers Ankita a new lens through which to view her own growth and self-discovery.

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inspiration

Key Point: Embracing Independence and Growth

Life inspiration: As you step into new experiences in your own life, like starting college or a new job, remember Ankita's journey of embracing independence amidst the challenges she faces. Her story teaches you that even when circumstances seem limiting, your adaptability and willingness to seize opportunities can open doors to self-discovery. Just as Ankita navigates her new environment with excitement and resolve, you too can choose to approach your transitions not with fear but with the eagerness to grow, learn, and forge your own path. This mindset can transform the uncertainties in your life into adventures, leading you toward the person you are meant to become.

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Chapter 2 Summary : Nothings gonna stop us now



Chapter 2: Nothing's Gonna Stop Us Now

In this chapter, we dive into college life, focusing on how groups form and bonds develop among students. The narrator notes that while their class of sixty students seemed to scatter like snooker balls, they eventually gravitated toward specific groups. For our protagonist, that means a close-knit circle of four friends: Suvi, Janie, Charu, and herself. Each friend brings a unique personality to the table—Suvi is lively and charismatic, Charu is studious and serious, and Janie is gentle and sensible.

The chapter humorously introduces a quirky college tradition

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involving their male professor, affectionately nicknamed Porukki-merki. This tradition, where female students stare at the professor during lectures, highlights the playful dynamic of a female-dominated college that lacks male presence.

Amidst these antics, the narrator confides in her letters to Vaibhav, her boyfriend, detailing the amusing classroom chaos.

As their correspondence grows, the letters become a vital connection between the two, illustrating the importance of communication in their relationship. Vaibhav expresses how the narrator gives his life purpose, and she secretly relishes the attention. When her 18th birthday approaches, Vaibhav decides he wants to call her, leading to a complicated but thrilling “Operation Mission Phone-call.”

Their attempts to connect on the phone are fraught with challenges, requiring stealthy planning around her family's schedule. When the much-anticipated phone call finally happens, it's filled with excitement and a delightful surprise: Vaibhav plays a love song, making the moment memorable. Their playful banter reflects their deepening affection, as each phone call becomes eagerly awaited and infused with warmth.

The chapter captures the thrill of young love, the innocent yet exhilarating complications of sneaking around, and the joy of

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finding connection through words—whether written or spoken. As the narrator hides from her parents, we see a blend of humor, youthful mischief, and burgeoning romance that make her milestones all the more precious. The sense that “nothing's gonna stop them now” resonates throughout, as their love grows amidst the chaos of college life.

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Critical Thinking

Key Point: Bonds formed in college can significantly shape an individual's identity and experiences.

Critical Interpretation: While the chapter depicts the excitement and vibrancy of college life through friendships and young love, it's essential to critically examine whether these relationships truly define personal growth. College is often idealized as a transformative period, yet many studies, including those by sociologists like Arthur Chickering and Linda Reisser in their work on student development, suggest that not all bonds forged in college are genuinely profound or lasting. Individual experiences can greatly vary, leading us to question the narrative that portrays such relationships as universally significant.

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Chapter 3 Summary : Election Selection

Election Selection

In this chapter, the excitement and chaos of college elections in Kerala unfold. Set against a politically charged backdrop, the elections at St. Agnes are notably free from the intense rivalries typically associated with this event. Instead, it resembles a spirited school election, featuring eight pivotal positions, including Chairperson and Arts Club Secretary. Ankita is unexpectedly thrust into the spotlight when her friend Suvi enthusiastically nominates her for the Arts Club Secretary role, backed by their roommates Smitha and Hannah. At first, Ankita is hesitant and overwhelmed by the idea of campaigning, but Suvi's infectious energy helps her embrace it. Soon, a wave of support from classmates ignites her competitive spirit. With Suvi as her campaign manager, they rally the students, canvas the campus, and create a lively atmosphere filled with chants and cheers.

Ankita finds herself gradually shedding her embarrassment as the campaign intensifies. Her main rival is a freshman, highlighting the advantage of her experience and support from peers. The election culminates in a triumphant victory

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for Ankita, supported by her friends and a fun investiture ceremony featuring a famous actor.

Following the elections, their responsibilities kick in with upcoming cultural events at the Management School of Cochin University. A blend of excitement and pressure propels Ankita and her fellow office bearers, notably Sanjana, Priya, and Juana, into preparations for the festival 'Symphony.' They eagerly plan for various events and exhibit a newfound confidence in their abilities.

As they engage in practice for the competitions, Ankita feels liberated in an all-female environment, discovering a sense of self that was previously masked by societal expectations. Through teamwork and support, they excel, showcasing impressive performances, particularly in western dance, which leads to their eventual win.

The chapter also hints at budding romance and friendship through Ankita's interactions with fellow students, namely Abhishek. Their playful exchanges, coupled with her friends' teasing, set the stage for an evolving relationship.

In the end, as the victory celebrations commence, Ankita's triumph brings happiness not just to her, but to her peers, solidifying bonds of friendship and teamwork as they strive to prove their worth collectively. This chapter cleverly intertwines themes of self-discovery, empowerment, and the vibrant dynamics of college life.

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Chapter 4 Summary : Girl on a Motorcycle

Chapter 4: Girl on a Motorcycle

In this chapter, we see the developing dynamic between Ankita and Abhi during a late-night motorcycle ride through Kerala. The ride begins with Ankita feeling anxious and guilty about being with Abhi, as she has a boyfriend, Vaibhav. Nevertheless, as they travel under the enchanting night sky, she relaxes and begins to enjoy the moment. As they stop for food at a local *thattu kada*, the tension rises when Abhi confesses his feelings for Ankita, declaring he loves her after only knowing her for a few days. Ankita is taken aback and feels the need to reveal her relationship with Vaibhav, but Abhi seems skeptical and dismissive about her relationship. This moment of vulnerability contrasts with the otherwise joyful atmosphere of their evening. After returning home, Ankita receives a call from her friend Suvi, who reveals that Abhi is looking for her and has left a letter explaining his feelings. Despite her initial reluctance, Ankita is intrigued and decides to read the letter later in

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private. When she does, she discovers Abhi's intense emotions articulated in a passionate and colorful way. His writing features the dramatic phrase "I LOVE YOU" written in what appears to be blood, which leaves Ankita both shocked and confused.

Through conversations with Suvi, Ankita grapples with her feelings for Vaibhav and the surprising connection she has with Abhi. Suvi encourages her to meet Abhi and clarify their situation. With a mix of excitement and guilt, Ankita eventually agrees to meet Abhi, while still hiding her intentions from Vaibhav.

The chapter explores themes of love, loyalty, and the complexities of young relationships as Ankita finds herself torn between her established relationship with Vaibhav and the overwhelming emotions stirred by Abhi's affection. It vividly captures her internal struggle and the thrilling yet daunting nature of new connections. As she prepares for her meeting with Abhi, we sense a shift in her journey—one filled with uncertainty and the allure of possibility.

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Critical Thinking

Key Point: Personal conflict and the complexity of attraction are central themes in young relationships.

Critical Interpretation: Ankita's dilemma, torn between her commitment to Vaibhav and her burgeoning feelings for Abhi, vividly illustrates the intricacies of human emotions. While Shenoy portrays a passionate connection that often entices individuals to explore new avenues of love, it's essential to recognize that these feelings may not always lead to a happy resolution. Research in psychology, like that of Finkel et al. (2017), suggests that such conflicts can lead to moral dilemmas and emotional turbulence, reflecting that the author's idealized portrayal of love should not overshadow the reality of emotional consequences.

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Chapter 5 Summary : Life is what you make it

Key Element	Summary
Setting	Ankita visits Abhi's home, feeling nervous yet excited.
Initial Interaction	Abhi greets Ankita warmly, creating a comfortable atmosphere.
Abhi's Grandfather	Introduced as friendly and supportive, enhancing warmth.
Bedroom Dynamics	Ankita feels daring and curious; Abhi's room reflects his personality.
Intimacy	Playful flirtations indicate growing intimacy; Abhi expresses deep affection.
Abhi's Vulnerability	Reveals troubled past and abusive relationship with his father.
Themes	Love, vulnerability, familial ties, and complexity of relationships.
Ankita's Conflict	She wrestles with feelings for Abhi and memories of Vaibhav.
Concluding Emotion	Ankita shows signs of opening her heart to new possibilities.

Summary of Chapter 5: Life is What You Make It

In this chapter, Ankita visits Abhi's home, feeling a mix of nervousness and excitement. When she arrives, Abhi warmly greets her, showcasing a comfortable familiarity that quickly puts her at ease. Their interaction highlights a budding connection, filled with playful teasing and light banter. Abhi introduces Ankita to his grandfather, who is friendly and supportive, adding to the warmth of the setting.

As they move to Abhi's bedroom, Ankita feels a sense of daring and curiosity, pushing through her initial hesitation.

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The bedroom reflects Abhi's personality, neatly organized and inviting. They share playful flirtations, indicating a growing intimacy between them. Abhi reveals his deep affection for Ankita, expressing sincerity and vulnerability, which astonishes her. Despite her instinct to guard her feelings, Ankita feels increasingly drawn to him.

The chapter takes a poignant turn when Abhi opens up about his troubled past, revealing scars from an abusive relationship with his father, who has strict expectations for him. This revelation not only shows Abhi's vulnerability but also challenges Ankita's perceptions of love and struggle. Their connection deepens as they share a moment of silent understanding, hands intertwined.

Caught between her feelings for Abhi and memories of her past with Vaibhav, Ankita's thoughts swirl, leaving her in a contemplative state by the end of the chapter. It marks a significant shift in her emotional landscape, suggesting that her heart is beginning to open to new possibilities. This chapter beautifully encapsulates themes of love, vulnerability, familial ties, and the complexity of human relationships.

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Critical Thinking

Key Point: The complexity of human relationships is shaped by individual vulnerabilities and emotional histories.

Critical Interpretation: In this chapter, Ankita's evolving feelings for Abhi bring forth the theme that relationships are not merely about romantic attraction, but also involve acknowledging the emotional baggage one carries. Abhi's reveal of his troubled past illustrates how personal struggles can affect interpersonal connections. While the author presents a narrative emphasizing vulnerability as a pathway to intimacy, readers should be cautious in accepting this perspective wholly. Not all relationships thrive on shared pain, and the pathway to emotional openness may not be universally applicable. Those looking for further insight into the dynamics of relationships and emotional complexity might refer to works like "Attached" by Amir Levine and Rachel Heller, where the interplay of attachment styles shapes romantic dynamics.

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inspiration

Key Point: Embracing Vulnerability

Life inspiration: In this chapter, Ankita's experience with Abhi illustrates the transformative power of embracing vulnerability. As you navigate your own life, remember that allowing yourself to be open and honest about your feelings can create profound connections with others. Just like Ankita, when you let down your guard and allow yourself to be seen, you may discover unexpected depth in your relationships. This chapter serves as a reminder that beautiful bonds are often forged in moments of sincerity and courage, encouraging you to step outside of your comfort zone and embrace the complexities of your emotions.

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Chapter 6 Summary : The needle swings

Chapter 6: The Needle Swings

In this chapter, Ankita finds herself at a crossroads of emotions following her visit to Abhi's house. Her friend Suvi eagerly prods her for details, teasingly suggesting that Ankita has lost her virginity. Ankita indignantly insists that they only held hands, but she admits to feeling a strong connection with Abhi, beyond what she planned.

Suvi, who has her own experience with relationships, encourages Ankita to be more open about her feelings. Their conversation delves into the complexities of love, intimacy, and the pressure of societal expectations. Suvi shares her own journey and reassures Ankita that exploring her feelings is part of growing up, while also reflecting on her past with different guys, including her current relationship with Ravi.

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Chapter 7 Summary : Destiny changes in moments

Destiny Changes in Moments

In this chapter, the narrator, Ankita, recounts a significant moment during the vibrant Mahatma Gandhi University Youth Festival, where she shares her first kiss with Abhi. The excitement of the festival quickly turns into chaos when the police show up, triggered by a scandal involving students and naval cadets.

The story unfolds over four days at the hostel, where the participants are a mix of vibrant youths enjoying newfound freedom while navigating the strict rules set by the office bearers, including Ankita. Suja, a rising star of the festival, seeks permission to stay out longer for a date, which sets off a chain of events rooted in impulsive decisions and peer influence. Sanjana, another office bearer, suggests they all attend a secret party at a hotel, where excitement turns into a desperate escape from the realities lurking outside.

The mood shifts dramatically once they leave the party for fresh air. It's during this quiet moment that Abhi and Ankita

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share a tender kiss. However, their bliss is shattered when they hear commotion from the police raiding the hotel, creating a palpable sense of fear and confusion. They choose to stay hidden as the chaos unfolds, complicating the aftermath of their experience.

The next day brings the shocking consequences of the night's events. Headlines label the Agnes girls shameful, and Sanjana and Suja, who were caught up in the scandal, face expulsion from the college. This public shaming reflects the conservative norms of Kerala, which holds strict views about women's conduct, revealing deep societal hypocrisy. The college authorities swiftly blame the girls, with Sister Evangeline's harsh response reinforcing a patriarchal stance that condones their earlier success while punishing their mistakes.

Themes of freedom, judgment, and the double standards faced by women emerge poignantly throughout this chapter. Ankita feels a sense of betrayal by her college for abandoning its students when they falter, echoing the sentiment that women's worth is often tied to their accomplishments but easily discarded when they misstep. The chapter closes with a somber realization that their victory in cultural competitions is overshadowed by a profound loss of dignity and unity among the students,

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leaving Ankita and her friends grappling with their identities and place within the college community.

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Critical Thinking

Key Point: Societal Hypocrisy and Judgement of Women

Critical Interpretation: One key point in this chapter is the stark critique of societal hypocrisy that scrutinizes women's behavior, revealing how their successes are quickly overshadowed by their perceived failures. This disparity in treatment, especially in conservative cultures like Kerala, demonstrates the burdens of judgment that women face. Ankita's experience underscores a vital conversation about how societal norms often dictate women's worth based on their adherence to traditional expectations, which can be both constrictive and damaging. While Preeti Shenoy highlights this theme to draw attention to the urgent need for social change, readers should contemplate the multifaceted nature of this issue—recognizing that not all perspectives align with the author's portrayal and that experiences around judgment and freedom can vary widely among individuals. For further insights, scholars like Judith Butler in "Gender Trouble" provide a nuanced examination of gender performance and societal expectations that contrasts with Shenoy's

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narrative.

Chapter 8 Summary : Ready to fly

Summary of Chapter 8: Ready to Fly

In Chapter 8 of **Life is What You Make It**, the story unfolds during the hectic and hopeful period of final year graduation. The protagonist, Ankita, has made a clear decision not to contest in the elections again, putting her focus on applying to top MBA institutes, which brings joy to her parents. As she commits to this path, her relationship with Vaibhav fades into a distant memory, replaced by a close bond with Abhi, who has become an integral part of her life.

Ankita and her friends form a dedicated study group to prepare for MBA entrance exams, diving into intense discussions and competitions. While Ankita excels in verbal ability, she struggles with quantitative tasks—an area where her study partner, Christy, outshines her. They frequently host seniors from previous MBA classes to gain insights and prepare for interviews. Yet, amidst this academic fervor, Ankita realizes that her determination may be at odds with Abhi's sentiment. He feels abandoned as she receives multiple interview calls, particularly from prestigious

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institutes, while he only secures a spot at CUSAT, which she does not consider her first choice.

When Ankita's father announces a job transfer to Bombay, Abhi becomes upset, wanting her to remain close. Their conversation takes a heated turn, with Abhi accusing Ankita of losing herself to pride, while she views his perspective as impractical. The confrontation reveals their contrasting priorities: Ankita's ambition versus Abhi's emotional attachment, filling the chapter with the tension of young love and personal aspirations.

By the end of the chapter, Ankita is resolute in her decision to pursue her dreams, confident that the vibrant city of Bombay will offer her opportunities that CUSAT cannot. With excitement for the new path ahead, she feels ready to take flight into her future, leaving behind the familiar and venturing into the unknown, embodying themes of ambition, independence, and the bittersweet nature of growth.

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inspiration

Key Point: Pursue Your Dreams With Determination

Life inspiration: In the midst of uncertainty and tension in your relationships, remember that prioritizing your own ambitions can lead you to fulfilling opportunities. Just as Ankita faced the difficult decision to leave behind what was comfortable and familiar, you too can embrace the unknown and set your sights on your personal goals. Whether it's pursuing further education or a desired career, your determination can empower you to step beyond boundaries and soar into new experiences, ensuring that you live life on your own terms. It's a reminder that sometimes, the path to personal growth requires leaving behind what no longer serves you, fostering a sense of independence that ultimately leads to a more authentic and fulfilling life.

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Chapter 9 Summary : Never Belittle Love

Element	Summary
Chapter Title	Chapter 9: Never Belittle Love
Main Character	Ankita
Setting	Coaching, preparing for a move to Bombay
Plot Overview	Ankita is excited about her future as she prepares for an MBA and cherishes moments with friends, but tension with Abhi looms after a fight.
Conflict	Ankita's unresolved feelings for Abhi and their communication breakdown after a fight.
Climax	An emotional meeting where Abhi proposes marriage but Ankita hesitates due to her ambitions.
Tragedy	Abhi goes missing and is later found drowned, leaving Ankita in despair and regret.
Key Quote	"Never belittle love" - Abhi's grandfather
Themes	Love, regret, communication, empathy
Lesson Learned	Ankita vows to cherish love and treat others with kindness, influenced by her experiences with Abhi.

Chapter 9: Never Belittle Love

In this poignant chapter, we follow Ankita as she prepares for a big move to Bombay, feeling like her life is finally falling into place with a prestigious MBA program and her brother's acceptance into a U.S. university. She enjoys time with her friends at a local restaurant, cherishing their last days together in Cochin. However, an underlying tension looms between her and Abhi, with whom she has not communicated

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since a fight, avoiding him as much as possible.

The plot thickens when Ankita's friend Suvi confronts her about her behavior towards Abhi, urging her to have a heart-to-heart conversation instead of leaving things unresolved. Reluctantly, Ankita agrees to meet Abhi, leading to an emotional encounter at Appu's, where Abhi expresses his love for her and even proposes marriage. Despite his feelings, Ankita struggles to commit, revealing that her ambitions extend beyond their town and that she cannot promise him anything. Their conversation ends with Abhi asking her to stay in touch.

Tragedy strikes when Suvi tells Ankita that Abhi has gone missing. The dread heightens when it is reported that his body has been found, having drowned after a night of drinking alone at the beach. Ankita is devastated and grapples with guilt over their last interaction, wishing she had been more considerate and communicated better with him.

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Chapter 10 Summary : Racing ahead

Summary of Chapter 10: Racing Ahead

In this chapter of "Life is What You Make It," the protagonist embarks on a transformative journey in Bombay, a city that captivates her with its diversity and vibrant culture. She quickly adapts to life as a college student, blending in with her peers and embracing her new environment. Her experiences at the management institute reveal the excitement of academic life, with ice-breaking activities that forge connections among classmates, many of whom hail from different backgrounds.

The protagonist finds herself in a unique group where she bonds with two other girls, Chaya and Jigna, and two boys, Joseph and Uday. This camaraderie blossoms, contrasted by the competitive nature of the academia where she feels energized and motivated. A newfound passion for jogging sparks a personal transformation, invigorating her both physically and mentally.

This physical activity becomes a routine that energizes her mornings, providing a fresh perspective on life. Her peers notice her heightened energy, leading to a humorous

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exchange when Joseph jokingly suspects her of using drugs to maintain such vigor. As the chapter progresses, her academic enthusiasm leads to meticulous studying techniques that she finds effective, resembling a photographic memory.

However, this success comes at a cost. Her obsession with perfection and academic excellence pushes her to study late into the night, leading to sleeplessness. Despite her success—topping her class with a score of 98—the protagonist struggles with feelings of inadequacy, fixated on the lost two marks.

Interestingly, as she excels, hints of an underlying struggle surface. The chapter ends with a sense that while she is currently on top of the academic world, there may be challenging times ahead. Themes of ambition, identity, and the consequences of intense pressure weave throughout this dynamic chapter, laying the groundwork for future developments in her journey.

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inspiration

Key Point: Embrace the Journey of Self-Discovery

Life inspiration: As you navigate your own path in life, remember that like the protagonist, it is through experiences and challenges that you discover your true self. Embrace the unknown, take risks, and allow your passions to guide you, whether it be in academics or personal interests. Just as she found empowerment through jogging and camaraderie, you too can find solace in activities that energize you, forming bonds that enrich your journey. Celebrate your successes, but also acknowledge and learn from the pressures you face, for they are all part of crafting your unique story.

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Chapter 11 Summary : Dancing in the dark

Chapter 11: Dancing in the Dark

In this captivating chapter, the protagonist, Ankita, attends a vibrant cultural festival that is filled with fun, flair, and excitement. Unlike her previous college events, this festival is all about entertainment rather than competition, thanks to a host of corporate sponsors. Ankita is swept away by the dazzling atmosphere, complete with disco lights and lively music.

Encouraged by her friends, particularly Joseph, Ankita is thrust onto the stage for a contest called JAM (Just a Minute). Despite her initial reluctance, she experiences an electrifying rush as she delivers a witty and comedic performance centered around Clint Eastwood's drinking preferences. Her confidence surges as she captivates the audience, leading to applause and cheers for her captivating presence.

As the night progresses, Ankita's transformation continues; she surprises herself by embracing the party atmosphere and

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eagerly joins the dance floor with Joseph. The Samba music intertwines perfectly with her newfound exuberance, and she dances with a playful flirtation, feeling beautiful and alive. However, her carefree moment takes a dark turn when she and Joseph venture to the terrace, where she notices troubling behavior from Uday, a peer using drugs.

Ankita, fueled by a wild sense of invincibility, climbs onto the edge of the terrace, shocking Joseph and igniting panic. Her sense of liberation spirals into reckless abandon, leading to a confrontation with another partygoer who mistakenly accuses her of being under the influence. Ankita, infuriated, lashes out in an uncharacteristic display of aggression, revealing a side of her personality she didn't know existed. In the aftermath, Joseph and her friends express their concern, voicing their fears about her actions. Ankita feels ashamed and bewildered by her behavior, wrestling with the realization that she can no longer fully trust herself. As the night winds down, she returns to Chaya's home, where feelings of shame linger. Lying awake, she grapples with her unpredictable emotions and fears, ultimately questioning her own identity and choices.

This chapter deftly explores themes of self-discovery, loss of control, and the unpredictability of youthful exuberance, offering a poignant glimpse into Ankita's struggle between fun and recklessness.

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Critical Thinking

Key Point: The Fine Line Between Freedom and Recklessness

Critical Interpretation: Ankita's experiences at the festival illustrate the delicate balance young individuals navigate between joy and impulsiveness. While the thrill of liberation can be intoxicating, it's crucial to understand that such moments can lead to dangerous consequences. This critical perspective encourages readers to reflect on their own boundaries and societal pressures. Although Shenoy presents a vivid celebration of life, one must consider that unchecked exuberance can obscure judgment, often leading to unforeseen repercussions. Studies have shown that impulsive behaviors in youth can correlate with increased risk-taking, emphasizing the importance of self-awareness and personal limits (Steinberg, 2004; Romer & Hennessy, 2007). Hence, while the narrative captures the essence of youthful vibrancy, it also serves as a cautionary tale about the perils of losing oneself in the pursuit of thrill.

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Chapter 12 Summary : The descent

Chapter 12: The Descent

In this chapter, we dive into Ankita's intense academic life, highlighting her challenging relationship with Professor R.S.V. Murthy, nicknamed “MM.” Known for his sarcasm and monotonous lectures, MM makes the marketing management course tedious, prompting students to zone out. However, Ankita stands out as she confidently prepares for a Monday test by studying diligently from a book by Philip Kotler.

Feeling empowered, she devises a unique color-coded note-taking technique. Anticipating the test questions, she even writes out the answers and is thrilled to find them closely matching the textbook. Inspired, she decides to share her notes with the entire class, believing it will help others succeed. On a sudden whim, she also purchases stickers, beautiful stationery, and art supplies, feeling an inexplicable urge to decorate her notes and create.

The night before the test, Ankita becomes consumed with her project, staying up all night happily creating her colorful sets of notes. When she arrives at college, her classmates are

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amazed by her work, gathering around to receive the notes. However, her friend Joseph expresses concern about the potential backlash from the professors, sensing that Ankita's impulsiveness might lead to problems.

Despite the warnings, Ankita aces her test effortlessly and feels a euphoric connection to her surroundings, observing the beauty in the landscape of her home.

Afterward, she paints a waterfall, offering her a moment of peace that soon spirals into frustration when she grapples with its artificiality. This triggers painful memories of Abhi, a significant figure from her past, forcing her to confront her unresolved feelings of love and loss.

In a cathartic outpouring, she writes an extensive letter to her friend Suvi, reflecting on her time with Abhi, her experiences, and her emotional turmoil. When completed, the letter surprises her in its length and the depths of her feelings, but she remains unaware of how it might be perceived by others later.

This chapter touches on themes of academic pressure, the quest for validation, the powerful impact of grief, and the fragility of mental health. Ankita's journey takes a darker turn as her impulsive actions lead her toward a troubling descent, setting the stage for future challenges.

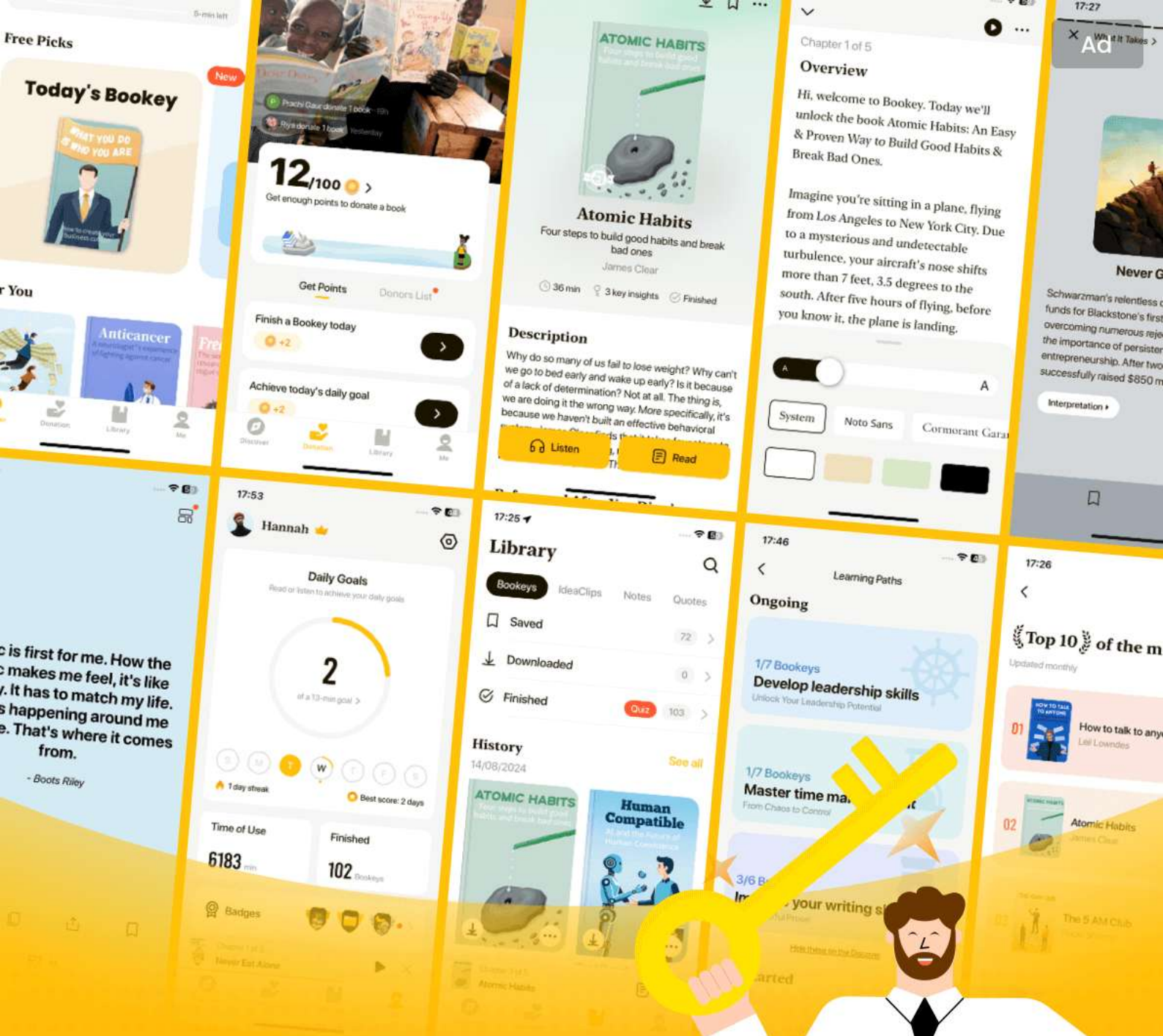
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Chapter 13 Summary : A stop gap relationship

Chapter 13: A Stop Gap Relationship

In this chapter, the protagonist delves into her passion for writing while grappling with the memories of her past love, Abhi. Corresponding with her friend Suvi reignites her desire to express herself through words, providing her a sense of relief and a way to keep Abhi's memory alive. While she initially considers confiding in Vaibhav about Abhi, she ultimately decides against it, opting instead to focus on her life in Bombay, her studies, and her newfound running hobby.

As the narrative unfolds, her fervor for writing intensifies. She fills notebooks with poetry and illustrations, channeling her emotions and experiences into her creative work.

However, her creativity comes under scrutiny from psychiatrists, who view her outpouring of emotion as a symptom of a mental disturbance, leaving her feeling terrified and guilty about her artistic expressions.

A key moment arises when, after a rainy day, she and her

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classmate Joseph decide to skip class and head to Juhu beach. Their casual outing takes a turn as she finds herself drawn to Joseph, and in a vulnerable moment, they share a kiss.

Though she feels no real love for him, the kiss becomes a desperate attempt to fill the void left by Abhi. Joseph, oblivious to her internal turmoil, expresses his feelings, leading to a complicated exchange where she ultimately reciprocates, despite her true emotions.

After their date, a wave of guilt washes over her, as she reflects on her feelings for Joseph, Abhi, and Vaibhav. She despises herself for her deception and involvement with multiple men, questioning her self-worth and identity. This culminates in her composing a poignant poem, "A Stop Gap Relationship," which encapsulates her feelings of emptiness and disconnection, comparing her emotional exchanges to those of a street whore who receives payment for intimacy. The chapter vibrantly explores themes of grief, the complexity of moving on, and the struggle between desire and guilt. The protagonist's journey through her emotions and her pursuit of creative expression highlights the tumultuous nature of human relationships and the quest for self-acceptance amidst heartache.

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Chapter 14 Summary : The day something died

Chapter 14: The Day Something Died

In this chapter, the protagonist grapples with a severe lack of sleep and the chaos both in her mind and her living space. She is overwhelmed by racing thoughts that transform into fantastical imagery, reminding her of a vibrant dream world, yet sleep eludes her, reflecting her internal turmoil. The mess in her room mirrors this chaos, revealing her neglect of personal care and her strained mental state.

Her parents' frustration peaks when her mother, unable to stand the disorder, decides to clean her room. Upon returning home, the protagonist discovers that her parents have found a letter from a boy named Abhi, which intensifies the family tension. Her father's explosive rage and her mother's harsh words underscore their inability to understand her feelings, leading to a confrontation that exposes deep-seated cultural conflicts around love, privacy, and expectations.

In the heated exchange, the protagonist feels trapped between her parents' traditional values and her own emotional reality.

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She struggles with the shame and guilt instilled in her by their accusations and becomes emotionally overwhelmed. The arrival of her parents' wrath coincides with the destruction of letters that hold significant meaning for her, representing lost love and feelings she cannot fully express. As her father burns the letters, including Abhi's heartfelt message, the protagonist feels an oppressive sense of loss, as if a part of her has been annihilated. The act serves as a symbolic end to her past connections, leaving her in emotional desolation. In desperation, she resorts to self-harm, believing that physical pain is more bearable than the emotional agony she experiences.

The chapter closes with her feelings of emptiness and a haunting realization that something within her has irrevocably changed. The transformation her father envisioned doesn't align with reality; she feels a void where her identity and hopes used to flourish, hinting at a loss that she struggles to define. This pivotal moment in her story encapsulates themes of familial expectations, the struggle for autonomy, the pain of love lost, and the consequences of suppressing one's true emotions.

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Chapter 15 Summary : Deeper down the bottomless pit

Chapter 15: A Descent into Fear

In this gripping chapter, we follow the protagonist, Ankita, as she experiences an overwhelming fear and panic that comes out of nowhere. Waking up in a state of dread, Ankita describes the sinking feeling in her stomach and the tightening grip around her throat—an emotion she cannot understand or explain. Despite the ordinary day unfolding outside her window, she feels completely absorbed by an inexplicable terror.

Seeking solace, Ankita turns to her father, who immediately recognizes that something is deeply wrong. Overcome with emotion, she bursts into tears, desperately articulating her fear yet unable to pinpoint its cause. Her parents attempt to comfort her, suggesting that her anxiety could stem from the pressures of her new MBA program, but Ankita knows it isn't simply about her studies. She feels helpless as the panic engulfs her, and efforts to calm herself seem futile.

As the day progresses, her dread transforms into a heavy

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melancholia, leaving her feeling miserable and devoid of motivation. Even participating in activities she usually enjoys becomes impossible. Her parents remain concerned but unsure how to help, attributing her feelings to the stress of adjusting to a new environment.

When Ankita decides to return to college after days of absence, she is met with a renewed wave of fear, again paralyzing her. Her mother, worried and anxious, tries to reassure her with platitudes about controlling her thoughts, but Ankita struggles to escape the dark void of her emotions. She battles the frightening thoughts swirling in her mind, desperately wanting to overcome them but feeling defeated instead.

This chapter uncovers themes of anxiety, misunderstanding, and the feeling of isolation that often accompanies mental health struggles. Ankita faces not only the fear itself but also the challenge of conveying her experience to those who care for her. The narrative highlights the complexity of mental health issues and foreshadows the difficult journey that lies ahead for Ankita, revealing an emotional depth that resonates with anyone who has felt lost in their own fears.

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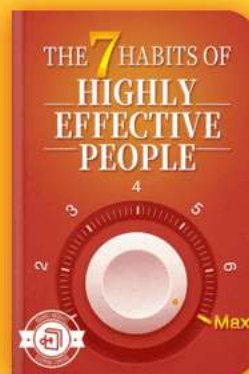
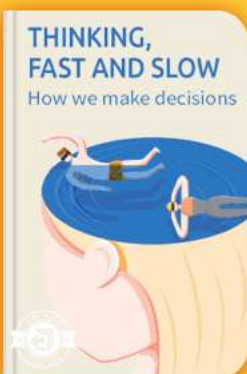


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Chapter 16 Summary : The ink blots

Chapter 16: The Ink Blots

In this chapter, we follow Ankita as she confronts her mental health struggles after moving to Bombay. Initially filled with hope, she soon finds herself overwhelmed by panic attacks and a deepening state of depression. Despite her family's belief that she would adapt, Ankita plunges into a dark void, feeling disconnected from her once vibrant self. Her academic aspirations fade, leaving her feeling lost and worthless.

Ankita's internal battle escalates as she struggles with reading and comprehension, ultimately culminating in a moment of despair where she attempts self-harm. This act shocks her parents, who are already anxious about her well-being. Their concern leads them to seek help from a psychiatrist, and despite her initial resistance, Ankita's vulnerability becomes evident.

At the psychiatrist's clinic, Ankita is forced to confront her feelings and past relationships under Dr. Mukta Nagraj's probing questions. Though she resents the process, she engages in psychological tests that reveal the depth of her

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symptoms. The psychiatrist diagnoses her with severe depression and prescribes medication, much to her parents' relief.

As they leave the clinic, Ankita's heart breaks at her father's hopeful reassurance. The chapter closes on a poignant note as she finds herself crying, overwhelmed by a mix of emotions—fear, helplessness, and the burden of expectations.

Ultimately, this chapter encapsulates themes of mental health, the pressures of academic success, and the complicated dynamics between Ankita and her supportive yet anxious parents, highlighting the often unseen struggles individuals face in silence.

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Critical Thinking

Key Point: Mental Health Awareness

Critical Interpretation: The chapter powerfully illustrates the gravity of mental health struggles and the often ignored complexities of such issues. It encourages readers to reflect on the persistent stigma surrounding mental illness and how societal expectations can exacerbate individual suffering. Preeti Shenoy adeptly portrays Ankita's descent into depression, challenging us to recognize that while familial support is crucial, it can also be suffocating and misaligned with the individual's experience. The expectation to conform to academic success can lead to feelings of inadequacy and hopelessness, as detailed by the National Alliance on Mental Illness (NAMI), which notes that societal pressures can significantly impact an individual's mental health. Readers should consider that Shenoy's portrayal may not capture everyone's experience with mental illness and that recovery paths can vary dramatically. Individual perspectives on mental health should not be disregarded, and what works for one person may not resonate with another.

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Chapter 17 Summary : The light goes out

Summary of Chapter 17: The Light Goes Out

In this poignant chapter, we dive into Ankita's deepening struggle with her mental health. Despite her parents' optimism surrounding the medication prescribed by Dr. Mukta, Ankita only feels worse. The two pills, a yellow and a white one, which her father administers to her daily, offer no relief, leaving her feeling like a prisoner within her own mind. The medications induce drowsiness, robbing her from the vibrant thoughts and emotions she once cherished—writing poetry and creating art—and replacing them with a terrifying emptiness.

Ankita's struggle is palpable as she describes the paralyzing numbness that envelops her days. She isolates herself, preferring the darkness of her room as she grapples with an overwhelming ache for feeling and expression. Activities that used to bring her joy now feel insurmountable. Her parents, well-meaning but helpless, try to support her, but their efforts often exacerbate her agitation and anger.

A noteworthy conversation with Dr. Mukta intensifies Ankita's feelings of fear and vulnerability. While her parents

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cling to the doctor's reassurances that things are improving, Ankita's internal turmoil remains unacknowledged. The introduction of a new medication leads to uncomfortable side effects, heightening her distress and feelings of inadequacy. As frustration builds, a violent outburst occurs as Ankita lashes out against her surroundings, symbolizing her internal chaos. The moment of self-reflection in the bathroom reveals the physical toll of her emotional struggles, further emphasizing her deterioration. Despite the false perception of improvement from her parents' perspective, Ankita feels increasingly trapped and despondent. In a dark and desperate conclusion, Ankita contemplates taking her own life as a release from her unbearable suffering, marking a critical turning point in her journey and underscoring the chapter's heavy themes of despair, isolation, and the urgent need for understanding and support in mental health.

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Chapter 18 Summary : A plan for a final exit

Key Aspect	Description
Protagonist's State	Deep despair after ineffective treatment and emotional pain.
Psychiatrist Experiences	Visits to Dr. Mukta and Dr. Kohli lead to feelings of being unheard and neglected.
Contemplation of Suicide	She considers various methods to escape her pain but discards them due to fear of failure.
Pivotal Moment	Overhears a conversation between Sanchit and Keerti, which distracts her from her intentions.
Father's Presence	Her father's loving search for her leads to a recognition of his pain and her own guilt.
Emotional Impact	Her father's tears help her acknowledge her struggles, marking a significant emotional breakthrough.
Themes	Love, pain, and the consequences of mental health struggles, hinting at a path towards recovery.

Summary of Chapter 18: A Plan for a Final Exit

In this intense chapter, the protagonist finds herself in the depths of despair after weeks of emotional pain and ineffective treatment from her psychiatrist, Dr. Mukta. Despite her parents' relentless hope for her recovery, she feels trapped and burdened by her existence. The visit to a more renowned psychiatrist, Dr. Kohli, proves to be another disappointing experience, as he neglects her feelings and simply hands out medication, leaving her feeling unheard and invisible.

As the protagonist sinks deeper into despair, she

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contemplates various methods of suicide, each plan fraught with fear and uncertainty. She desires a final escape from her pain, envisioning different methods but discarding them one by one due to the prospect of failure or added suffering.

Ultimately, she resolves to jump off her building's terrace, believing it to be a sure way to end her life.

On the fateful night, as she prepares to jump, she experiences a moment of pause when she overhears a heartfelt conversation between Sanchit and Keerti, which momentarily distracts her from her intentions. Just then, her father appears, having sensed something was wrong and fearfully searching for her. His presence, filled with love and silent agony, profoundly impacts her. In that moment, she recognizes the depth of her father's pain and her own overwhelming guilt.

Her father's tears of helplessness shatter her numbness, leading to an emotional acknowledgment of her struggles as she quietly apologizes. This moment signifies a pivotal change, evoking the complex themes of love, pain, and the dire consequences of mental health struggles. As the chapter closes, the relationship between the protagonist and her father is strained yet deepened, hinting at a path toward recovery and understanding through love and vulnerability.

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Chapter 19 Summary : No way out

Chapter 19: No Way Out

In this chapter, we follow Ankita's harrowing experience as she prepares for admission to a renowned mental health facility in Bangalore. The atmosphere is heavy as she sits anxiously in the waiting area, feeling like just another number in a line of patients seeking help. When she finally meets with the psychiatrist, her discomfort amplifies as he probes into her life, asking detailed questions reminiscent of her previous sessions with Dr. Mukta. After her parents have a discussion with the senior doctors, they deliver the crushing news: Ankita needs to be admitted for observation.

Ankita is overwhelmed by feelings of betrayal and anger as she faces the reality of being institutionalized; she feels trapped, scared, and alone. Despite her pleas, her parents insist that this is for her well-being after her struggles with mental health. Left in a stark hospital room, she battles an intense fear and longing for her mother's comfort. The weight of abandonment washes over her as she lashes out in rage, feeling unheard and forgotten.

Her breakdown is tumultuous, leading to an extreme

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emotional outburst where she screams in despair, feeling utterly lost in her turmoil. In response to her episode, the staff intervenes, administering a sedative that brings her a brief sense of calm. As she regains consciousness, she grapples with shame and confusion over having lost control. The following day, Dr. Madhusudan explains to Ankita that she has a severe case of bipolar disorder. He draws a graph to illustrate how her condition works, emphasizing its cyclical nature. This moment provides a pivotal shift in Ankita's perception of her illness, as she learns that her mental struggles are not her fault but a health issue requiring treatment, akin to any physical ailment.

Dr. Madhusudan addresses her fears surrounding Electroconvulsive Therapy (ECT), clarifying its purpose and potential benefits. It becomes a critical turning point for Ankita as she begins to understand that there is hope and that she is not alone in her suffering. His reassurance and the promise of support ignite a flicker of hope in her, marking the beginning of her journey towards healing.

This chapter poignantly explores themes of mental health, the stigma surrounding it, and the deep need for understanding and compassion in moments of despair. Ankita's journey reflects the struggle many face with mental health issues, highlighting the importance of professional help and the transformative power of empathy and support.

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Critical Thinking

Key Point: The Importance of Recognizing Mental Health as a Medical Condition

Critical Interpretation: In this chapter, the turning point for Ankita comes when she learns about her condition being a severe case of bipolar disorder. While the author, Preeti Shenoy, presents this understanding as a critical step toward healing, it's essential to scrutinize this perspective. The stigma surrounding mental health issues often leads people to view them through a negative lens; however, this view can be counterproductive as it may suggest that individuals can 'will away' their struggles. While understanding one's condition is undeniably vital in recovery, it's imperative to acknowledge that not everyone will respond similarly to treatment or even find the same level of accountability empowering. Research shows that mental health is complex, often involving a mix of biological, psychological, and social factors (American Psychiatric Association, 2013; Kessler et al., 2005). Thus, while Shenoy's narrative encourages an accepting view of mental health challenges, it is crucial for readers to consider that recovery processes vary significantly, and

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dependence on clinical labels may sometimes inadvertently obscure the individuality of one's experience.

Chapter 20 Summary : A tiny ray of hope

20 A Tiny Ray of Hope

In this poignant chapter, Ankita finds herself in a stark private room, feeling trapped yet oddly safe. The emptiness mirrors her troubled mind, but it also offers her a cocoon from the chaos outside. The absence of her parents and the pressure of her previous life gives her time to breathe and reflect.

Each day, she encounters the doctors. The junior doctors' morning visits are uneventful, but she eagerly anticipates her chats with Dr. Madhusudan in the evenings. His kind, understanding nature and insightful words become her lifeline, offering her hope for recovery. He prescribes her Lithium, emphasizing its importance for her condition, which is more serious than the depression previously diagnosed. Dr. Madhusudan shares his own family story of loss and resilience, creating a deep connection with Ankita. He reassures her that her struggles are not her fault and encourages her to envision a future beyond her MBA

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program. This conversation ignites a flicker of hope in Ankita, paving the way for introspection about her choices and possibilities.

As she opens up about her fears of returning to her previous life, Dr. Madhusudan informs her that she will be moved to the Occupational Therapy wing for better care. Though apprehensive about not seeing him as often, she feels grateful for his support.

Upon arriving at the new wing, Ankita is astonished by the welcoming environment, which resembles a resort rather than a hospital. She embraces the structured routine laid out for her, marking a shift from her previously unproductive days.

The chapter culminates as Ankita joins others in the recreation room, discovering art supplies that awaken memories of her past joy in painting. This moment signals a shift in her emotional state — she longs to reconnect with her creativity and find happiness once again, hinting at the resilience and potential for recovery within her. The theme of hope and the power of human connection resonate profoundly in this transformative chapter.

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Chapter 21 Summary : Faith is a powerful thing

Chapter 21: Faith is a Powerful Thing

In this chapter, Ankita begins to find solace in painting, inspired by the flowers outside her window. This marks a turning point as she immerses herself in creativity, creating a lively impression of the blossoms. During this artistic moment, she is interrupted by two young men, Sagar and Anuj, who show interest in her artwork. Initially hesitant, Ankita feels a growing comfort in their company as they share a meal and bond over movies and books.

For the first time in a long while, Ankita truly enjoys food, savoring the flavors and experiencing the joy of eating. She realizes she can connect easily with Sagar and Anuj, and nobody probes into her troubled past, allowing her to relax and feel a sense of security.

Ankita has an epiphany about her perception of normality, deciding she can mask her feelings and present a facade of being 'normal.' This realization empowers her; she starts to see herself as someone who has overcome isolation. The

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chapter also explores themes of camaraderie, healing, and the simplicity of human connection.

As the day progresses, Ankita learns about the various activities available, opting to play basketball with Anuj. The physical exertion and camaraderie invigorate her, and she revels in the joy of being alive. After their game, they discuss their psychotherapy sessions, and Ankita hopes to see Dr. Madhusudan, a senior doctor she admires.

Her hope is momentarily dashed when she meets Dr. Namita, a junior doctor who initially makes her uncomfortable, having access to her personal history. However, Dr. Madhusudan arrives soon after, easing her anxieties with reassurance.

Throughout their discussion, he reveals the insights gained from Ankita's writings and art, which helps in diagnosing her bipolar disorder. Although she feels vulnerable and exposed, there's an odd sense of relief in knowing her struggles are understood. Dr. Madhusudan speaks of the connection

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Chapter 22 Summary : One step at a time

Key Points	Description
Gift from Dr. Madhusudan	Ankita receives children's books with a note encouraging her to take “one step at a time.”
Therapy Sessions	Ankita struggles with reading and comprehension during her sessions with Dr. Namita but perseveres.
Supportive Environment	Her new friends Anuj and Sagar create a sense of camaraderie, sharing their challenges and fostering solidarity.
Achievements	After weeks of effort, Ankita reads her first book entirely by herself, boosting her self-worth.
Physical Exercise	Engaging in physical exercise contributes to her mental and physical health improvements.
Musical Gifts	Anuj and Sagar gift her music tapes, emphasizing the celebration of small moments in life.
Reflection	Ankita reflects on her transformation while listening to Elvis Presley, acknowledging life's unpredictability and the importance of resilience.

Summary of Chapter 22: One Step at a Time

In this chapter, Ankita receives a surprise gift from Dr. Madhusudan—a collection of children's books that hold sentimental value as they belonged to his childhood. Initially puzzled by the gift, she finds comfort in the vibrant illustrations and the note encouraging her to take “one step at a time” on her journey to recovery.

As she begins her therapy sessions with Dr. Namita, she struggles with reading and comprehension, feeling frustrated and helpless when she cannot grasp even simple sentences.

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Trying to regain her lost abilities, Ankita decides to take Dr. Madhusudan's advice seriously. Though she feels like she has been reduced to a child learning to read, she doesn't give up and persists with Dr. Namita's help.

The supportive environment created by her new friends, Anuj and Sagar, fosters a sense of camaraderie among the patients. Their shared experiences and mutual understanding bring Ankita comfort as they discuss their own challenges. This bond between them highlights a theme of solidarity in the face of mental health struggles.

As the weeks progress, Ankita notices improvements, eventually achieving the milestone of reading an entire book without the need for dictation. Her joy at this accomplishment parallels her growing sense of hope and self-worth. Alongside her healing journey, she gets physical exercise, improving both her mental and physical health. Amidst these changes, Anuj and Sagar gift her music tapes, emphasizing the idea that life should be celebrated, reinforcing the chapter's theme of finding joy in small moments. As Ankita listens to Elvis Presley, she reflects on her transformation and growth since the beginning of her journey, recognizing the unpredictable nature of life and the importance of resilience.

In summary, this chapter beautifully illustrates Ankita's

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gradual recovery process through small victories, the support of friends, and the rediscovery of joy in reading and life.

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inspiration

Key Point: Take Life One Step at a Time

Life inspiration: Imagine standing at the foot of a mountain, daunting yet beautiful, and every challenge looms like an insurmountable peak. But as you grasp the concept of taking 'one step at a time', you realize that each small effort—like Ankita learning to read again—brings you closer to your goal. This gentle reminder empowers you to embrace your own journey of recovery and growth, finding strength in the small victories that pave the way for greater achievements. Instead of feeling overwhelmed by the distance ahead, you can celebrate each accomplishment, just as Ankita did, as you discover joy in the process rather than fixating solely on the destination. Each word you read, or every achievement you earn, echoes the rhythm of progress, teaching you that persistence and resilience are keys to unlocking the beautiful possibilities that life holds.

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Chapter 23 Summary : I am the master of my fate

Chapter 23 Summary: I am the Master of My Fate

In this emotional chapter, Ankita prepares to leave the mental health facility where she has spent weeks recovering. She feels a mix of happiness and trepidation, grateful for the guidance of Dr. Madhusudan, who recognizes her progress and encourages her to pursue her talent for writing and painting. He warns her about the importance of continuing her medication, reinforcing her journey towards self-acceptance.

As a parting gift, Ankita creates heartfelt cards and paintings for the staff and her friends, Sagar and Anuj. Their interactions are filled with warmth, laughter, and a bittersweet sense of farewell, underscoring the bonds they've formed during their shared struggles. Sagar's affectionate hug and Anuj's playful antics highlight the deep friendships that blossomed amidst adversity.

When Ankita returns home, she notices a shift in her parents' demeanor, sensing their vulnerability and concern for her

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well-being. She realizes she has changed significantly, no longer seeing her future in the corporate world. Instead, she decides to drop out of her MBA program to pursue a Creative Writing course, a decision that reflects her newfound appreciation for life—one filled with meaning beyond traditional success.

Ankita's letter to Vaibhav marks a pivotal moment as she opens up about her experiences and transformation. She articulates how her struggles with mental health have reshaped her view on life, recognizing that happiness lies in love, friendship, and living each day fully. She acknowledges her growth and expresses a desire to stay connected, even if she is now a different person.

As she sends the letter, Ankita celebrates her newfound strength and joy in simple moments, embracing life with optimism. The chapter closes with her feeling empowered, ready to embrace her future and the gift of each day.

Overall, this chapter encapsulates themes of healing, friendship, the importance of mental health, and the courage it takes to carve one's own path in life.

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inspiration

Key Point: Embrace Your Creative Passions

Life inspiration: Ankita's transformative decision to pursue a Creative Writing course instead of sticking to the corporate path signifies a powerful message: you have the ability to shape your own future. Imagine stepping out of the confines of what society expects of you and instead listening to your heart's calling. This chapter urges you to acknowledge your passions and talents as integral to your identity and fulfillment. Just as Ankita sends her heartfelt letter and begins to express her true self, you too can discover that true happiness lies in embracing your uniqueness and pursuing what genuinely ignites your spirit. The courage to change course and prioritize what matters most can lead to a life rich with meaning and connection.

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Chapter 1 | Quotes From Pages 23-28

1. We have to accept the things that we cannot change.
2. It was an exhilarating feeling — like a caterpillar emerging out of a cocoon.
3. I was no longer a juvenile and could be arrested too.
4. It instilled in me a kind of awe and respect, something similar to what one feels when one enters a building that belongs to the Armed forces in the country.

Chapter 2 | Quotes From Pages 29-42

1. A year flew by and I did not even feel it pass.
2. I liked being adored. I liked the feeling of being so important to someone. I liked being the centre of someone's world.
3. Once you know what direction to take, finding the path to it becomes easy.

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4. Take care, ok? I love you.

5. The whole song took about four and a half minutes. In between, I tried telling him to stop playing the song and that I get the sentiments behind it. But he continued playing it till the very end.

Chapter 3 | Quotes From Pages 43-61

1. Weren't you the head girl in school?

2. "Vote for Ankita," they continued screaming and my classmates who were in the canteen joined in.

3. Calm down. There is no other option. We will lose points if there is a no-show. You'll just have to step in.

4. The maximum time allowed is six minutes anyway. Three minutes is really not bad," she insisted.

5. Confidence in our abilities soared with this victory. It wasn't easy but we had done it.

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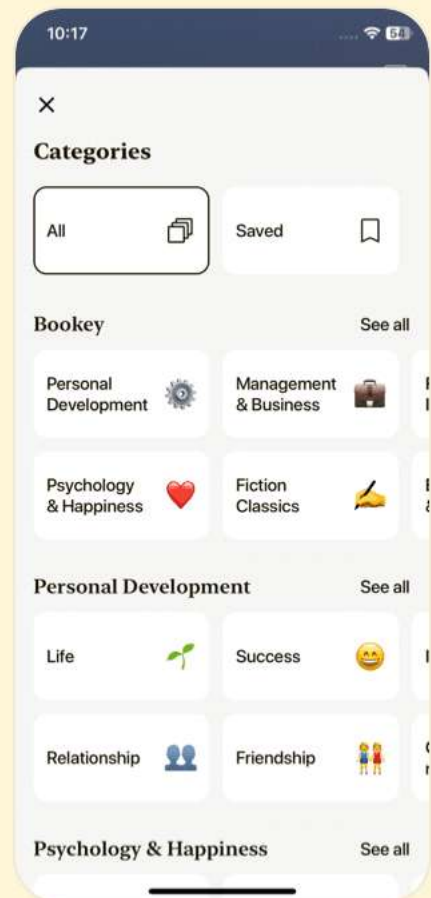
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Chapter 4 | Quotes From Pages 62-77

1. We are what our thoughts have made us. So take care what you think. Thoughts live. They travel far.
2. You have given my life a new direction and nothing has mattered so much to me till now.
3. I love the way you speak, the way you smile and the way you are so easily shocked.
4. There will always be confusion when it comes to matters of the heart, but it is essential to understand one's true feelings first.
5. You may not have won a prize that day but in my mind you were clearly a winner.
6. I cannot think of anything else but you.

Chapter 5 | Quotes From Pages 78-89

1. Life is what you make it, Ankita. I am willing to wait for you forever. That is how much I care.
2. There are no buts and no ifs in life.
3. God, morning, evening and night, day in and day out all I

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can think about is you.

4.I wanted you to believe me so badly. I don't go around expressing my love to every girl I meet.

5.I am not blind. I can see. But all this is so sudden for me.

Chapter 6 | Quotes From Pages 90-94

1.Look, I am beginning to like him a lot more than I intended to. I have no idea what to do. And what do I tell Vaibhav?

2.I had decided to do it and I did it. That was all. It did not matter with whom.

3.The needle had swung in Abhi's favour and there was no question of turning back.

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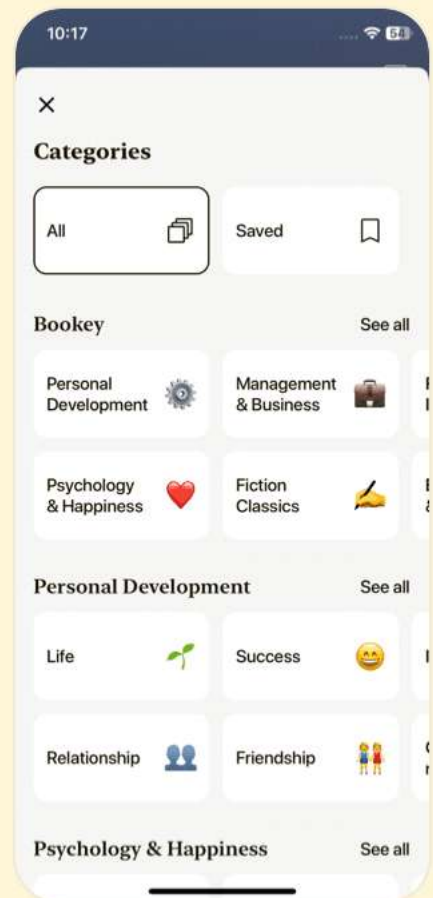
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Chapter 7 | Quotes From Pages 95-108

1. Sometimes decisions that are taken in the nick of a moment are the ones that have the power to affect a whole train of events that follow.
2. They say destiny changes in moments sometimes.
3. I had always wondered how my first kiss would be... I was surprised that it just came instinctively and Abhi seemed to know what he was doing.
4. What hurt me most and disillusioned me completely was the reaction of the college authorities.
5. As long as the girls kept winning and bringing the laurels home, they were adored.

Chapter 8 | Quotes From Pages 109-114

1. I was determined to make it.
2. Whatever it was, I was delighted beyond measure when I got an interview call from not one, but four institutes...
3. Abhi felt I was being hard-hearted. I felt I was being practical and rational.
4. How could he ask me to give up my dream?



5. Bombay beckoned and I was more than ready to fly.

Chapter 9 | Quotes From Pages 115-130

1. Never belittle love.

2. Adopt the pace of nature. Her secret is patience.

3. I dream of things that never were and ask why not.

4. At least keep in touch, that is all I ask.

5. The sound of a grown up man crying is one of the loneliest, saddest sounds I have ever heard.

6. I wished a hundred million things. I wished a hundred million things. They remained just wishes which would taunt me all my life.

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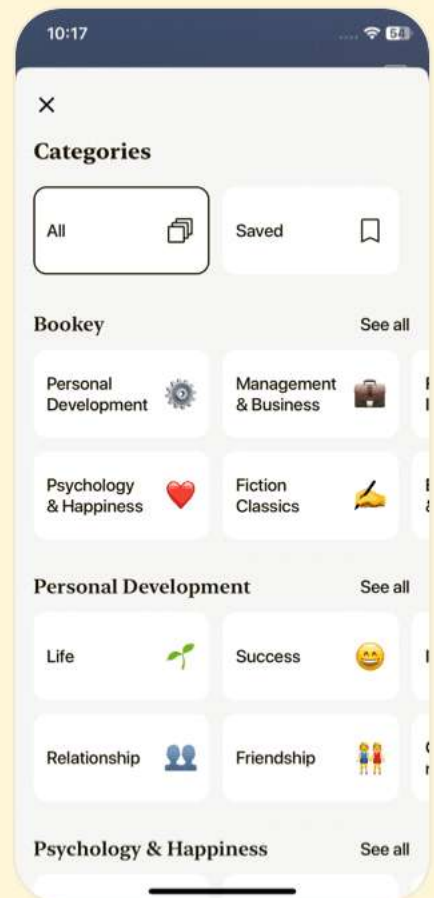
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Chapter 10 | Quotes From Pages 131-143

1. Bombay is like the proverbial elephant being described by five blind men. Everyone feels a tiny bit of it and is convinced that their version of it is the real Bombay.
2. In Bombay, people measured distances by time taken to commute.
3. What I had not anticipated was running out of film. Most days I would be studying way past 2.00 A.M.
4. It was almost as though I had a photographic memory.
5. But I was far from happy. I kept looking at the paper and kept getting angry that I had lost two marks.

Chapter 11 | Quotes From Pages 144-153

1. I was feeling invincible, irresistible, charming and at the top of the world.
2. I was dancing with wild abandon and gyrating wildly.
3. A strange sense of absolute assuredness combined with a manic wild abandon was engulfing me now.
4. I had no idea myself what I had been doing. It was the first



time in my life that I realized that I could not trust my own self anymore.

5.What if you had fallen over?

Chapter 12 | Quotes From Pages 154-165

1.I wanted to share my ‘colour coded’ way of remembering things with everybody, so they too could benefit.

2.I had been so busy with my studies that I had never really paid attention to it.

3.I became angry that it was man made and not real.

4.I felt a deep sense of regret.

5.I wished I had told him I would. I wished I had told him that Bombay wasn't far away and we could meet in the holidays...

6.The irony was that I had thought it would soothe me, when I wrote it.

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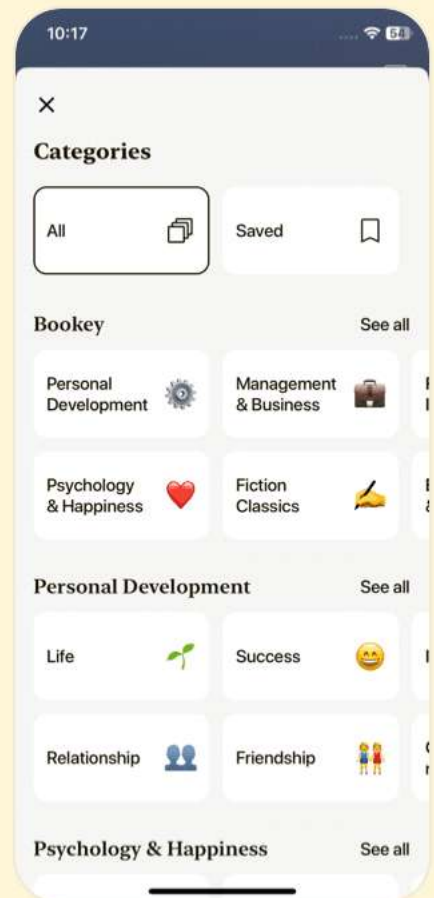
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Chapter 13 | Quotes From Pages 166-176

1. I was filled with an almost coercive need to capture these thoughts somewhere.
2. I would learn to stamp out any creativity and learn what 'normal' and 'appropriate' behaviour was.
3. I was kissing him for Abhi, I was kissing him as repentance for never having admitted to Abhi that he did matter to me.
4. I loathed myself for lying to Joseph. I loathed myself for not having admitted the truth to Abhi.
5. The only difference between her and her sisters on the street... is that they receive payment in cash and she receives it through emotions.

Chapter 14 | Quotes From Pages 177-189

1. Something inside me had died that day along with those letters.
2. It was a bedlam, a hotchpotch of a million different things that just existed side by side with no relation or connection to each other.
3. I had lost a lot of weight. My already thin frame now

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looked positively haggard.

4. Feelings are powerful and logic was crushed under its weight.

5. I wanted it to stop. I wanted no more of this agony.

Chapter 15 | Quotes From Pages 190-201

1. I felt afraid. Extremely afraid. There was no logical reason to it, really.

2. "What happened? What happened?" he kept repeating. I had no idea what happened.

3. There is nothing to be afraid of. I am here now. Don't worry. I am here.

4. I decided to try what he suggested. But the next day too I did not feel any better.

5. The fear was gone but it was replaced by a depressing feeling which made my heart feel like it weighed a ton.

6. It was the beginning of a sharp curve, a painful detour, a journey that would lead me completely away from my destination.

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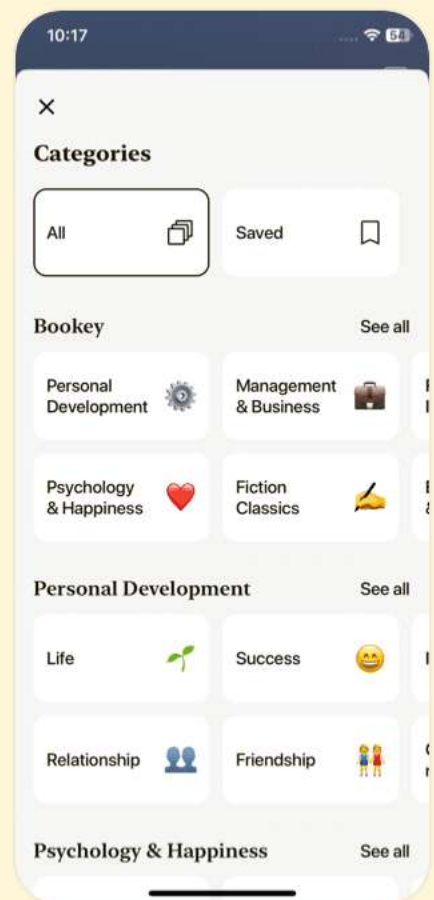
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Chapter 16 | Quotes From Pages 202-215

- 1.It was like I was dead from inside.
- 2.I felt like a broken toy.
- 3.I was grateful that he did not mention the incident with the knife.
- 4.Life, as I knew it, had vanished, handing me in its place this mockery to make sense of.
- 5.Everything I had taken for granted had disappeared.

Chapter 17 | Quotes From Pages 216-226

- 1.I felt a little bit like a prisoner but the only place that I was trapped in, was inside my own mind.
- 2.The agony of it made me want to weep and wail out my sorrow but even grief eluded me.
- 3.To be trapped like this in one's own body is a fate worse than death. With death, at least there is an end. Here the suffering is endless.
- 4.I wanted my poems back. I wanted my pictures back. They were the only hope I had and they had vanished.
- 5.I was already broken but this crushed me completely and



totally.

Chapter 18 | Quotes From Pages 227-236

1. What he drugged me with, seemed to me thrice the amount that Dr. Mukta had given. I was perpetually like a zombie and had settled down into my new persona with ease.
2. There was only one way out of this mess and that was to end my own life.
3. I remembered my night at the fresher's party on another terrace in Bombay where I was teasing Joseph, threatening to jump off. The irony of the situation struck me now.
4. I had never seen my dad cry, but that night I saw the tears of defeat and agony that he blinked back.
5. I wished he had [shouted at me]. His words would have been easier to bear than his silence.

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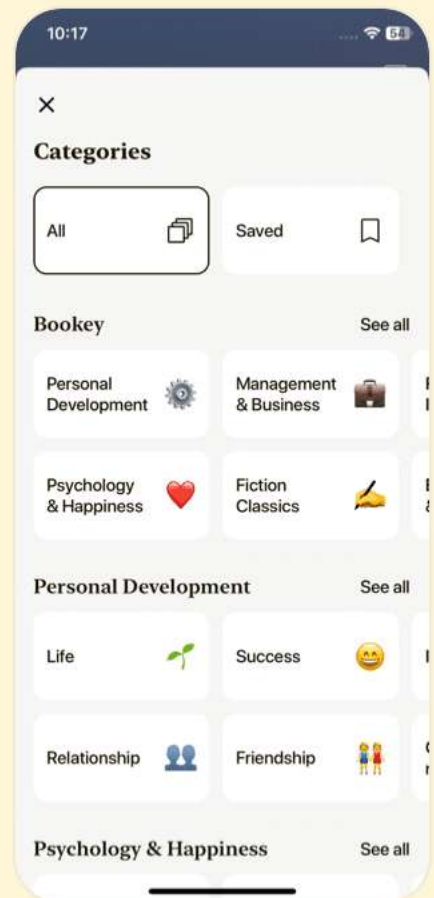
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Chapter 19 | Quotes From Pages 237-249

- 1.It is an illness like any other illness... when you have an illness of the mind, you come to us.
- 2.People have a stigma about it. They do not understand the severity of it. People simply cannot snap out of it, they need to be treated in order to get better.
- 3.It can be life saving and can produce dramatic results...suicide attempts are rare after administering it.
- 4.The feeling of worthlessness and extreme depression... are going to come in waves. You must not give in. You have to co-operate and help us to fight it.
- 5.He was offering me the last vestiges of hope and I was clinging to it with the desperation of a drowning person.

Chapter 20 | Quotes From Pages 250-262

- 1.I did not have my parents hovering over me urging me to take medication. I did not have the pressure to go back to college. I did not feel compelled to read. I did not have to do anything. My time was my own.

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- 2.It is indeed amazing how words and kindness have the power to heal, perhaps much more than medicines.
- 3.Life is a gift, Ankita. We should not throw it away.
- 4.Nothing is lost just because you dropped out of MBA. It is not the be-all and end-all of life.
- 5.For the first time in many months, I thought about the future and what other things I could do if I did not complete my MBA.
- 6.You have just survived one of the most terrifying mental ordeals a human being can face.
- 7.I wanted to paint once more.

Chapter 21 | Quotes From Pages 263-275

- 1.Faith is a strange and a powerful thing and it can work miracles.
- 2.I discovered that I could converse easily. Nobody asked any questions about why I was there and what my past was. Perhaps that was an unsaid understanding that existed amongst everybody there.
- 3.I made up my mind right then, that if that was all it took to

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be termed 'normal', that was how it would be from now on.

No matter what I felt, I would never show it.

4. I had implicit faith in Dr. Madhusudan's words. I felt if he said I could manage it, I would. I believed him with all my heart.

5. Sometimes all one needs is a strong anchor, a person you can trust blindly. Someone who will lead you on, be there for you and never let you down.

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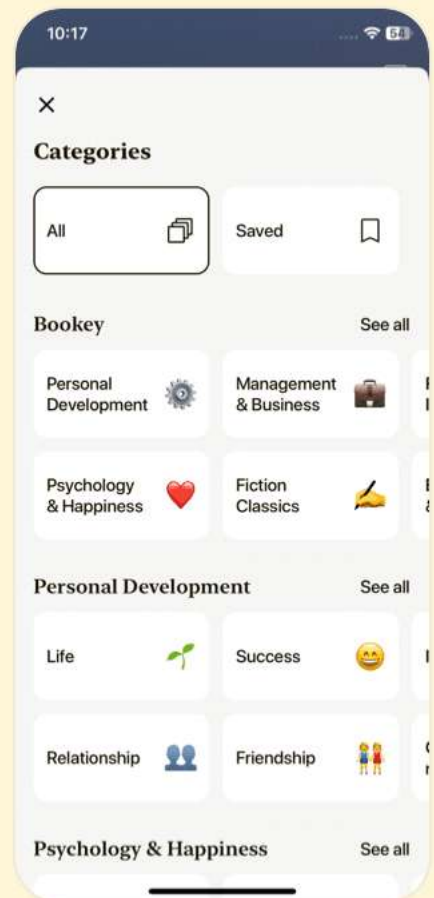
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Chapter 22 | Quotes From Pages 276-288

1. One step at a time, Ankita. We're getting there!
2. You have been under tremendous stress in the past months.
Don't worry. You are making good progress.
3. Life is a celebration!
4. If reading children's books was what it took, to get back my reading and comprehension abilities, I would do that.
5. Gradually the sobs eased. I got up and washed my face when I heard the attendant knocking on the door calling out for outdoor time.
6. I felt like dancing and shouting out to the world and telling everyone who passed by 'Look I am able to read! Look I am able to remember!
7. That evening I broke the news to Dr. Madhusudan. He was as delighted as I was. 'That is indeed wonderful Ankita! Well done!'
8. Most importantly you learn to pay heed to what others do not tell you.

Chapter 23 | Quotes From Pages 289-301

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1. You have a real talent for writing as well as painting. Do something about it. Do not waste it. Not everybody is gifted. You are and you are indeed lucky.
2. I have put a lot of time and a lot more of my love into these paintings which I have made... To me, this is the greatest gift I can ever give somebody.
3. Life was too precious to not do the things one wanted to.
4. Sometimes, we do not appreciate fully what we have unless we lose it.
5. Each day, I feel, is a gift to be truly cherished.
6. Love and faith can indeed work miracles.
7. I am a totally different person from the one you knew.
8. I was celebrating being alive and there was a strong feeling in my heart that the celebrations would last a lifetime now.

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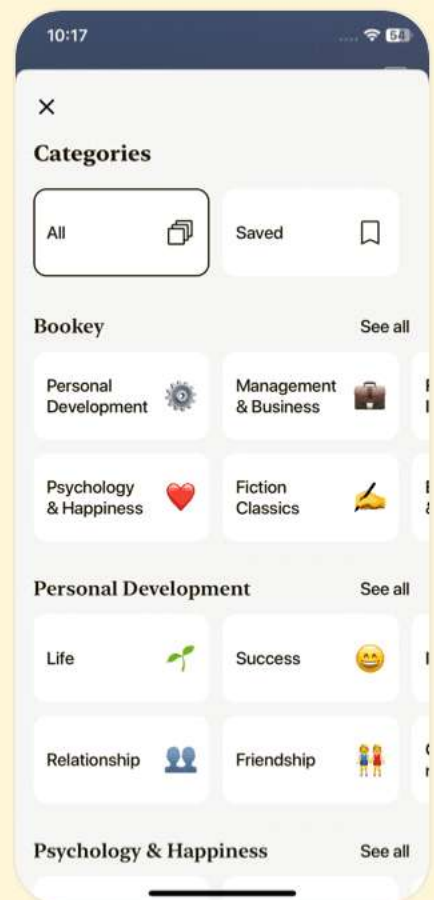
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Life is What You Make It Questions

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Chapter 1 | A new world| Q&A

1.Question

What can we learn about dealing with disappointment from the character's experience with college choices?

Answer:The character experiences disappointment when her parents refuse to let her study in Delhi, but she learns to accept things she cannot change. This teaches the importance of resilience and adaptability in the face of circumstances beyond our control. Instead of dwelling on what she can't have, she focuses on making the best of her situation in the college she has been accepted into.

2.Question

How does the change from school to college represent personal growth in this chapter?

Answer:The transition from school to college symbolizes a pivotal moment of personal growth and newfound

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independence. The character feels exhilarated at being a college student, shedding the restrictions of school life, and embracing the new responsibilities and freedoms of adulthood. This transformation is akin to a caterpillar emerging from a cocoon, highlighting that significant life changes can lead to new opportunities and self-discovery.

3.Question

What does the character learn from the college environment compared to her previous schooling?

Answer: In college, the character encounters a vibrant and diverse environment with a majority of women, contrasting her previous experiences in co-educational schools. This overwhelming presence of female peers allows for a different social dynamic, fostering a sense of camaraderie and empowerment among women that she hadn't experienced before. It teaches her to appreciate female camaraderie and the unique perspectives women bring to education.

4.Question

How does the author use the college setting to evoke a sense of pride and belonging?

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Answer: The author describes the college with vivid imagery and details that instill awe and respect. From the historical architecture to the impressive trophies and the warm welcome from the principal, each element contributes to a sense of pride in being part of this institution. This setting becomes a source of identity and belonging for the character, giving her motivation to excel and embrace her new role.

5.Question

What underlying theme is reflected in the character's excitement about college?

Answer: A key underlying theme is the quest for identity and independence. The character's excitement about college reflects a turning point where she can begin to carve her own path distinct from her family's expectations. This journey of self-discovery is crucial during young adulthood, highlighting the significance of pursuing one's passions and embracing the freedom that comes with new opportunities.

6.Question

How does the concept of waiting for letters emphasize the theme of connection in the chapter?

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Answer: The concept of waiting five days for letters emphasizes the theme of connection by showcasing how communication was more deliberate and meaningful before the digital age. The anticipation of receiving thoughts and news from a friend symbolizes the strength of their bond, suggesting that true connections can endure distance and time. It highlights the value of patience in maintaining relationships.

7.Question

What does the character's childhood memories reveal about her family dynamics?

Answer: The character's memories of being restricted from socializing with boys illustrate the conservative and strict nature of her upbringing. This dynamic underscores the protective instincts of her parents while also highlighting her desire for freedom and social exploration. It presents a common tension in familial relationships where parental boundaries can conflict with a growing need for independence.

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Chapter 2 | Nothings gonna stop us now| Q&A

1.Question

How do groups form in college according to the author?

Answer:The author describes that while there is a natural instinct to gravitate towards people with similar interests or backgrounds, the formation of groups in college can sometimes feel random and chaotic, much like snooker balls scattering after a shot. However, upon deeper reflection, it's evident that these groups come together for specific reasons and shared experiences.

2.Question

What does the author's group consist of, and how do they interact?

Answer:The author's group consists of four members: Suvi, Janie, Charu, and herself. Each has a distinct personality—Suvi is dynamic and energetic, Charu is studious and ambitious, and Janie is gentle and caring. Despite their differences, they bond and support each other

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through shared activities, notes exchange, and fun, resembling a patchwork quilt.

3.Question

What unique tradition does the college have, and how does it impact the students?

Answer:The college has a humorous and somewhat outrageous tradition called the 'Great-Agnes-embarrass-a-guy-by-staring-at-his-crotch' during lectures of their male professor. This bizarre tradition unites the girls in their playful rebellion against the professor, showcasing their newfound freedom and breaking of inhibitions inherent in a women's college atmosphere.

4.Question

How does the author express her feelings towards her pen pal, Vaibhav?

Answer:The author expresses profound affection for Vaibhav through their growing correspondence. Her letters become an essential link between them and provide a sense of anticipation and joy. She finds happiness in the thought of

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him and enjoys being the center of his attention, feeling important and adored.

5.Question

What challenges does the author face when trying to communicate with Vaibhav?

Answer:The author faces significant obstacles in communicating with Vaibhav due to a lack of mobile phones and her strict family. She must meticulously plan phone calls to avoid detection by her family, dealing with interruptions and the need for secrecy, making their communication feel like a covert operation.

6.Question

What significant moment occurs on the author's 18th birthday?

Answer:On the author's 18th birthday, Vaibhav successfully calls her, surprising her with a love song played over the phone, which deeply moves her. This moment solidifies their connection and marks a joyful milestone, pushing her feelings for him to new heights.

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7.Question

How does the author feel about the efforts Vaibhav makes for their calls?

Answer:The author feels touched and amazed by the lengths Vaibhav goes to in order to maintain their communication.

His thoughtfulness, such as preparing a song for her birthday call, makes her feel cherished and adored, enhancing her affection for him.

8.Question

What is the impact of their weekly phone calls on the author?

Answer:The weekly phone calls become a source of joy and excitement for the author, providing her with something to look forward to. They enrich her life, allowing her to share experiences and feelings, broadening her emotional world and filling her with happiness.

9.Question

How does the author describe the feeling of waiting for a phone call?

Answer:The author vividly describes the feeling of waiting

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for a phone call as agonizingly slow, filled with anticipation and longing. This feeling underscores her emotional investment in her relationship with Vaibhav, amplifying the significance of their communication.

10.Question

What lesson does the author imply about relationships and connection?

Answer: The author implies that relationships are built on consistent communication, shared experiences, and emotional investment. The way she cherishes her connection with Vaibhav emphasizes the importance of making an effort to maintain bonds, no matter the obstacles.

Chapter 3 | Election Selection| Q&A

1.Question

What motivated Ankita to contest for the position of Arts Club Secretary despite her initial reluctance?

Answer: Ankita was initially resistant to the idea of contesting for Arts Club Secretary because she felt unprepared and intimidated by the responsibilities.

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However, her friends, particularly Suvi, were excited and supportive, walking her through the campaigning process, which ignited a sense of competitive spirit within her. Suvi's infectious enthusiasm and the backing of her classmates encouraged Ankita to embrace the challenge.

2.Question

How did Ankita's experience in her school election differ from her college election?

Answer:In school, Ankita was chosen as head girl without needing to campaign or ask for votes, while in college she had to actively campaign and seek support, which was a learning curve. This shift forced her to confront her fears and insecurities in a more public setting.

3.Question

What role did teamwork play in Ankita's success during the elections?

Answer:Teamwork was crucial to Ankita's success; her friends took on various roles and responsibilities, from



managing campaign logistics to creating promotional materials. Suvi acted as her chief campaign coordinator, motivating other students to participate, which created a supportive environment and contributed significantly to Ankita's eventual victory.

4.Question

What did Ankita learn about herself through her campaign experience?

Answer: Throughout her campaign, Ankita learned that she was capable of handling challenges and could inspire and lead others. Despite her initial fears, she found confidence in her abilities and embraced the experience of public speaking and leadership.

5.Question

Why was the investment of the new office bearers significant for Ankita and her friends?

Answer: The investiture ceremony marked a formal acknowledgment of their new roles and responsibilities, serving as an important milestone in their college journey. It

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represented not only their achievements but also their commitment to making a positive impact in their college, fostering a sense of belonging and pride in their school community.

6.Question

How did external circumstances, such as the cultural festival, impact Ankita's development as a leader?

Answer: The cultural festival, 'Symphony', posed immediate challenges that tested Ankita's leadership skills and adaptability. When an unexpected absence left her college without a participant in English Elocution, she was thrust into a position where she had to take the stage unexpectedly. This experience taught her to think quickly and act decisively, crucial traits for a leader.

7.Question

What was the significance of winning the overall championship at the festival for Ankita and her peers?

Answer: Winning the overall championship at the cultural festival was a major boost to Ankita and her classmates as it

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validated their hard work and teamwork. It reinforced their belief in their collective abilities and increased their confidence, setting a positive tone for their future endeavors.

8.Question

How did Ankita's perception of her college environment change throughout her experiences during the elections and festival?

Answer:Ankita's perception of her college environment shifted from feeling intimidated and out of place to recognizing it as a supportive, empowering community. She discovered a sense of freedom and camaraderie among her peers, allowing her to express herself confidently and embrace her role within the group.

9.Question

What impact did the competitive atmosphere of the college elections have on Ankita's personal growth?

Answer:The competitive atmosphere challenged Ankita to step out of her comfort zone, confront her fears, and develop resilience. It provided her with opportunities to learn valuable skills in public speaking, teamwork, and leadership,

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contributing to her personal growth and self-discovery.

10.Question

How did Ankita's relationship with her peers evolve through her campaign process?

Answer: Ankita's relationship with her peers grew stronger as they rallied around her during the campaign. The shared experience fostered friendship, loyalty, and collaboration, creating lasting bonds among the group. This camaraderie was vital for her emotional support and motivation throughout the challenging campaign.

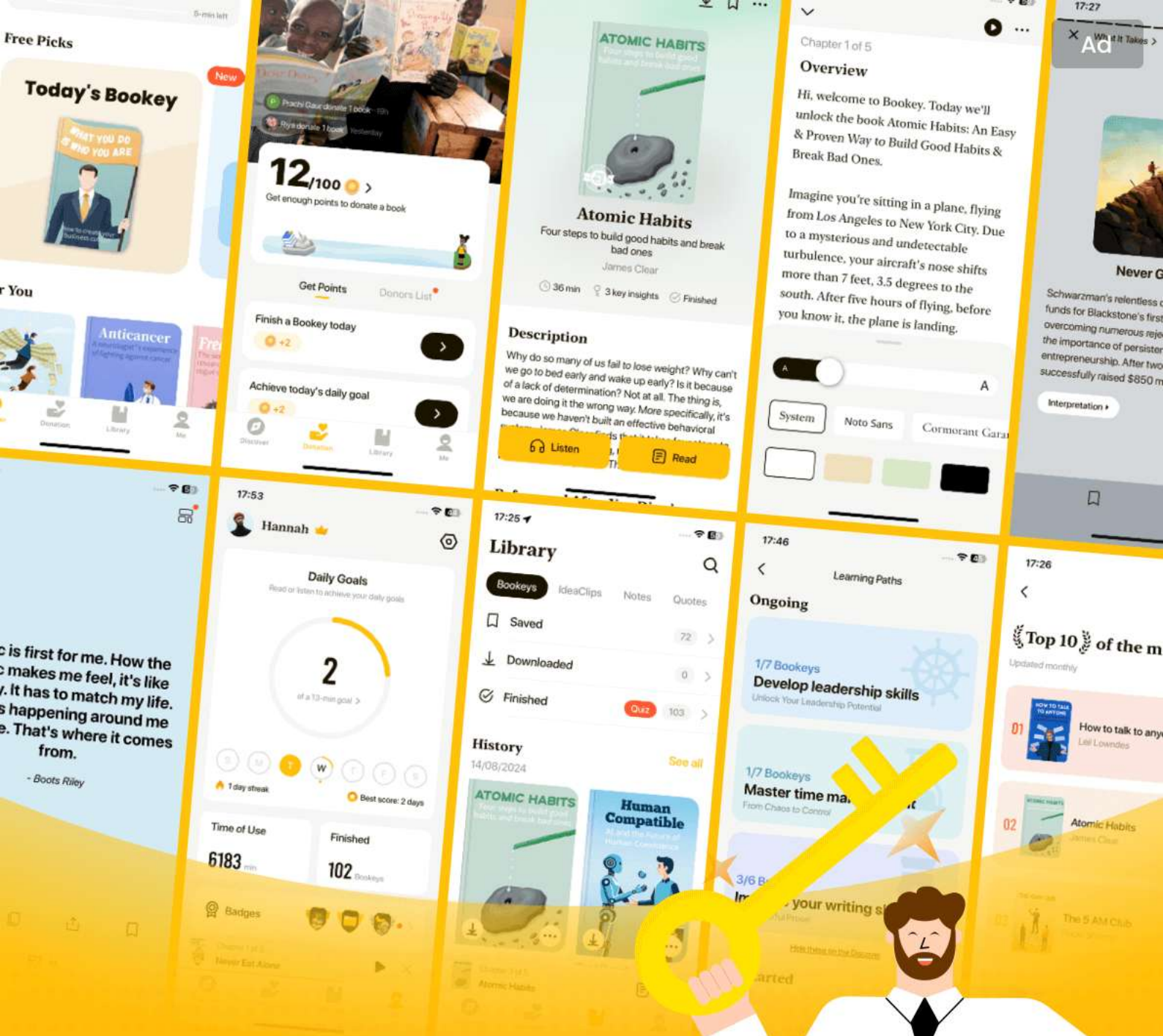
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Chapter 4 | Girl on a Motorcycle| Q&A

1.Question

What does the nighttime motorcycle ride symbolize for Ankita?

Answer:The motorcycle ride symbolizes a transition for Ankita from her perceived loyalty to Vaibhav into a possible exploration of new relationships and experiences. As she moves further away from home with Abhi, she feels moments of guilt but also begins to enjoy the freedom and beauty of the night, reflecting her internal struggle and desire for change.

2.Question

How does Abhi's behavior during the ride impact Ankita's feelings?

Answer:Abhi's carefulness and attentiveness during the ride help Ankita to relax and feel safe, shifting her initial discomfort into a sense of enjoyment. His concern for her comfort allows her to open up and enjoy the moment, setting

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the stage for her emotional awakening.

3.Question

What does the brass lamp symbolize in the context of Kerala culture as depicted in the story?

Answer:The brass lamp symbolizes hospitality and the welcoming of prosperity into homes, indicating the cultural values of Kerala. As Ankita observes the lamps flickering in the darkness, it represents the warmth of the local traditions and a contrast to her internal conflict.

4.Question

What do Abhi's feelings for Ankita reveal about his character?

Answer:Abhi's bold confession of love within just a few days demonstrates his passionate, impulsive nature. His heartfelt and sincere expressions show that he is deeply moved by Ankita, suggesting that he is willing to take risks in love and is not afraid of vulnerability.

5.Question

How does Ankita feel about Vaibhav as she interacts with Abhi?

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Answer: Ankita is conflicted about her feelings for Vaibhav during her interactions with Abhi. While she tries to honor her relationship with Vaibhav, she cannot help but be drawn to Abhi's charm and sincerity, which causes her guilt but also excitement about new possibilities.

6.Question

What does Abhi's letter represent for Ankita's emotional journey?

Answer: Abhi's letter symbolizes the intensity of his feelings and his desire for a deeper connection with Ankita. It acts as a catalyst for her emotional journey, forcing her to confront her own feelings about love, loyalty, and the choices she must make between her current relationship with Vaibhav and the potential future with Abhi.

7.Question

What role does the conversation between Ankita and Suvi play in the narrative?

Answer: The conversation between Ankita and Suvi serves as an important dialogue that helps Ankita process her emotions

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and dilemmas. Suvi's encouragement and playful teasing provide a contrast to Ankita's guilt, pushing her to consider her desires and the possibility of exploring new love.

8.Question

What does the contrast between the thatu kada and upscale dining symbolize?

Answer:The contrast between the thatu kada, a humble roadside eatery, and upscale dining symbolizes the simplicity and authenticity of local experiences over societal expectations. It illustrates how true pleasure can be found in sincere moments, like sharing delicious food, as opposed to pretentious or judgmental environments.

9.Question

How does the imagery of the night sky affect Ankita's mindset?

Answer:The imagery of the night sky, filled with stars and bathed in moonlight, evokes a sense of wonder and possibility in Ankita. It reflects her shifting emotions from tension and guilt to an appreciation for beauty and adventure,

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hinting at her growing feelings for Abhi.

10.Question

What does Ankita choose to focus on during her ride rather than her guilt?

Answer: Ankita chooses to focus on the beauty of the night and the enjoyable moments spent with Abhi, which helps her temporarily push aside the guilt she feels about Vaibhav. This mental shift marks a significant step in her exploring her own feelings and desires.

Chapter 5 | Life is what you make it| Q&A

1.Question

What can we learn from Ankita's hesitation about visiting Abhi despite his invitation?

Answer: Ankita's initial hesitation reflects the common struggle with self-doubt and the fear of vulnerability when stepping into new relationships. It highlights how sometimes we might question our impulses and decisions, especially when they involve deeper emotions and connections. It's essential to

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recognize that taking risks, like meeting someone new, can lead to meaningful experiences, even if they initially feel intimidating.

2.Question

How does the relationship between Ankita and Abhi demonstrate the importance of communication?

Answer:The candid conversations between Ankita and Abhi reveal the depth of their connection, grounded in openness. Their ability to share feelings, uncertainties, and stories about their pasts enhances their bond and builds trust. This underlines the essential role of communication in relationships; it allows individuals to understand each other better and fosters a safe space to express emotions, laying the groundwork for a potential romantic partnership.

3.Question

What does Abhi's expression of love and vulnerability signify in the context of their relationship?

Answer:Abhi's willingness to openly express his feelings, even to the point of showing his injuries, signifies a deep

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level of vulnerability and trust. It illustrates that love isn't just about grand gestures but also about being honest about one's pain and struggles. This expression of vulnerability acts as a crucial element in deepening their emotional connection, as it invites Ankita to see Abhi's true self beyond the surface.

4.Question

How can the phrase 'Life is what you make it' be interpreted in the context of Ankita's experiences?

Answer: This phrase encapsulates the idea that our choices and attitudes shape our experiences and outcomes. For Ankita, it manifests as she learns to navigate her feelings for Abhi, shifting from uncertainty to a willingness to open up and embrace new possibilities. It suggests that despite life's challenges or the influence of others, individuals have the power to direct their paths based on their choices and actions.

5.Question

In what way does Ankita's growing connection with Abhi signify a turning point in her narrative?

Answer: Ankita's realization of her feelings for Abhi marks a

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pivotal shift in her emotional landscape, representing a move away from her past attachment to Vaibhav. This change indicates a readiness to explore new relationships and the complexities of love, demonstrating how human connections can transform us and reframe our perceptions of joy and companionship.

6.Question

What does Abhi's relationship with his father reveal about the challenges individuals face in familial bonds?

Answer: Abhi's strained relationship with his father, highlighted by violence and differing values, illustrates the profound impact of family dynamics on personal identity and emotional well-being. It underscores that familial bonds can sometimes be fraught with conflict, and the struggle for acceptance can lead to deep personal challenges, shaping how one perceives love and connection outside the family.

7.Question

How does the setting of their interaction (Abhi's room) contribute to the development of their relationship?

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Answer: The intimate setting of Abhi's room plays a crucial role in fostering a close atmosphere that encourages vulnerability and openness. This private space becomes a sanctuary where they can express their thoughts and feelings without external judgment, allowing their connection to deepen as they share personal stories and secrets.

8.Question

Why is it significant that Ankita chooses to hold Abhi's hand at a moment of vulnerability?

Answer: Ankita holding Abhi's hand symbolizes empathy and connection during a time of emotional revelation. This simple gesture reinforces the bond they share, as it signifies mutual support and understanding, conveying that she acknowledges his struggles and is willing to be a source of comfort and strength.

9.Question

What role does humor play in Ankita and Abhi's interactions?

Answer: Humor acts as a bonding mechanism within Ankita

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and Abhi's conversations, helping to ease tension and create a more relaxed atmosphere. Despite the serious topics they address, moments of lightheartedness allow them to connect on a more playful level, enhancing their rapport and making their relationship feel more genuine and enjoyable.

10.Question

How does the chapter illustrate the theme of seeking approval and acceptance in relationships?

Answer: Ankita's desire for Abhi's approval and her own hesitance to reveal her home life highlight a universal theme of seeking acceptance in building relationships. This dynamic demonstrates the importance of mutual respect and acknowledgment, revealing that individuals often strive to validate their connections through shared experiences and understanding.

Chapter 6 | The needle swings| Q&A

1.Question

What can we learn about friendship and support in the context of tough emotional experiences?

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Answer: Suvi supports Ankita in exploring her feelings about Abhi, showing that friendship can provide necessary perspectives amidst emotional turmoil. Suvi's reassurance helps Ankita feel understood and less alone in her emotional confusion.

2.Question

How can one deal with guilt and confusion in relationships?

Answer: Ankita confronts her feelings of guilt and confusion but chooses to push aside her discomfort. Acknowledging one's feelings, like Suvi did, can lead to clarity. It's important to communicate with trusted friends who can offer different perspectives on the situation.

3.Question

What is the significance of being true to oneself when navigating relationships?

Answer: Ankita is torn between her feelings for Abhi and loyalty to Vaibhav. The chapter illustrates that understanding

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one's own desires and values is crucial in relationships, as ignoring those can lead to internal conflict.

4.Question

What does the chapter say about tradition versus modern perspectives on relationships?

Answer: Ankita's hesitation about her virginity represents traditional views, while Suvi indicates a more modern, casual approach to physical intimacy. This juxtaposition showcases the evolving attitudes towards relationships among young people.

5.Question

Why is it important to reflect on one's emotional needs in complex relationship situations?

Answer: Ankita starts to realize that her emotional needs might be changing as she begins to prefer Abhi's company over Vaibhav's. Reflecting on emotional needs helps individuals make informed decisions that align with their true feelings.

6.Question

What can we learn about personal growth through

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relationships illustrated in this chapter?

Answer: The evolving relationship between Ankita and Abhi signifies personal growth for Ankita. Through her experiences, she moves from feeling guilty and confused to recognizing her emotions, suggesting that relationships can facilitate self-discovery and maturity.

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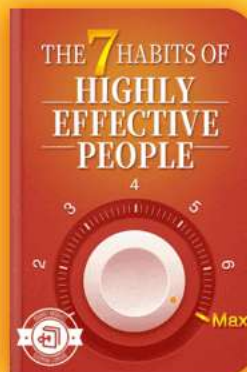
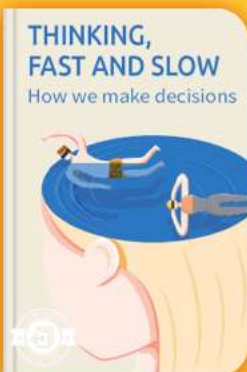


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Chapter 7 | Destiny changes in moments| Q&A

1.Question

What does the opening scene of the chapter reveal about the nature of first experiences?

Answer:The opening scene reflects the unpredictability of first experiences, such as the protagonist's first kiss with Abhi. Unlike the romanticized versions often depicted in media, it is overshadowed by fear and anxiety from a sudden interruption by the police. This contrast highlights that real life is often different from portrayals in books and movies.

2.Question

How does the party serve as a turning point in the characters' lives?

Answer:The party symbolizes a moment of freedom and youthful recklessness for the characters. It exposes them to new experiences and relationships, but also sets them on a path that leads to unexpected consequences, illustrating how

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moments of fun can have lasting impacts on life.

3.Question

What lessons can be taken from the influence of peer pressure depicted in the chapter?

Answer:The chapter shows how peer pressure can lead to decisions taken without full consideration of the consequences. Suja's decision to sneak out to the party, encouraged by her peers, demonstrates the importance of being mindful of one's choices and the potential fallout from succumbing to societal or peer expectations.

4.Question

What does the author's critique of the college authorities reveal about societal norms regarding women?

Answer:The critique highlights the double standards women face, especially regarding their behavior and reputations. The harsh punishment of the girls involved in the incident reflects societal intolerance towards women's independence and a deeply ingrained belief that a woman's value is tied to her 'virtue'.

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5.Question

How does the narrative indicate the transformation of 'destiny' throughout the chapter?

Answer:Destiny is portrayed as being fragile and quickly altered by circumstances. The carefree enjoyment of the party leads to a drastic change, as the police raid abruptly shatters the girls' lives, illustrating that life can change in an instant based on seemingly trivial decisions.

6.Question

In what way does the story convey the theme of accountability and its consequences?

Answer:The story emphasizes that individuals, especially young women, often bear the brunt of accountability for societal transgressions. The expulsion of Suja and Sanjana without recognition of their autonomy stresses the theme of society punishing those who dare to step outside established boundaries.

7.Question

What message does the author send regarding the pursuit of personal freedom?

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Answer: The author suggests that while the pursuit of personal freedom is vital for growth and self-discovery, it can come with significant risks, particularly in societies with rigid norms. The events of the party serve as both a celebration and a cautionary tale about embracing independence in a world that often seeks to repress it.

Chapter 8 | Ready to fly| Q&A

1.Question

What does it mean to pursue one's dreams despite challenges?

Answer: Pursuing dreams often requires resilience and the ability to push through hardships. In the chapter, the protagonist Ankita focuses on her goal of securing a spot in a top MBA program, demonstrating that determination is essential, irrespective of distractions like love or friendships. She sees a clear distinction between her ambitions and Abhi's emotional appeals, illustrating that personal dreams should take precedence when one

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has worked hard for them.

2.Question

How should one handle relationships when pursuing personal goals?

Answer:Balance is crucial. Ankita struggles with her relationship with Abhi, who wants her to prioritize their connection over her ambitions. The chapter implies that while relationships matter, personal growth and pursuing one's aspirations must not be hindered by others' expectations. Setting boundaries while being empathetic to others' feelings is vital.

3.Question

What role does competition play in personal growth?

Answer:Competition can be a powerful catalyst for personal growth and improvement, as seen through Ankita's competitive dynamic with Christy. They challenge each other, helping both to excel in their studies. This friendly rivalry fosters a culture of hard work and ambition, highlighting that competition can lead to positive outcomes

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when approached constructively.

4.Question

What lesson can be learned from Ankita's decision to move to Bombay instead of CUSAT?

Answer:Ankita's choice signifies the importance of prioritizing one's opportunities over comfort zones. She recognizes that staying in CUSAT would mean sacrificing her ambitions for the sake of her relationship. This teaches us that recognizing valuable opportunities and seizing them, even at the risk of leaving familiar environments, is crucial for personal success.

5.Question

How should one respond to criticism from loved ones when pursuing goals?

Answer:Criticism from loved ones, like Abhi's harsh words, can be difficult to process. It's important to differentiate constructive feedback from jealousy or negativity. Ankita reflects on Abhi's comments but ultimately decides to continue on her path, emphasizing that one should listen,

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reflect, but also trust their instincts and values when pursuing dreams.

6.Question

What mindset is necessary for success in competitive situations like entrance exams?

Answer:A mindset of determination, resilience, and strategic planning is essential. Ankita understands this and commits to hard work alongside her peers. She balances practice and collaboration, showing that while personal effort is vital, leveraging support from others can enhance performance in high-stakes environments.

7.Question

How does one maintain clarity of purpose amid distractions and emotional ties?

Answer:Maintaining clarity requires self-awareness and the ability to set clear priorities. Ankita's journey illustrates that while relationships and feelings can complicate decisions, keeping one's goals front and center and reminding oneself of the sacrifices made for those dreams helps maintain focus

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during emotionally turbulent times.

8.Question

What can we learn from Ankita's feelings of pride after her successes?

Answer:Ankita's pride serves both as a motivating factor and a point of contention in her relationships. It highlights that while confidence in one's achievements is important, one should remain humble and empathetic. Balancing pride with humility in the face of others' challenges fosters stronger, supportive relationships.

Chapter 9 | Never Belittle Love| Q&A

1.Question

What lesson does Ankita ultimately learn from her relationship with Abhi?

Answer:Ankita learns the importance of not belittling love and recognizing its value, regardless of the circumstances or challenges faced. Her regrets after Abhi's death teach her to appreciate love more openly and to communicate her feelings honestly.

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2.Question

How does the relationship between Ankita and Abhi evolve throughout the chapter?

Answer:Initially, Ankita distances herself from Abhi after a conflict, but ultimately she is compelled to meet and communicate with him. Their interaction reveals deep feelings, but also leads to a painful realization that they are on different paths, culminating in tragedy.

3.Question

Why does Suvi urge Ankita to talk to Abhi, and what does this reveal about friendship?

Answer:Suvi encourages Ankita to communicate with Abhi because she sees that Ankita is causing him unnecessary pain by not being honest about her feelings. This reflects the value of true friendship, where caring friends look out for each other's emotional well-being and encourage healthy communication.

4.Question

What is significant about the setting of 'Appu aur Pappu' during Ankita's meeting with Abhi?

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Answer: The setting of 'Appu aur Pappu' symbolizes both nostalgia and the bittersweet nature of their relationship. It serves as a backdrop for tender moments but also represents the looming separation and the weight of Ankita's decision not to fully embrace their love.

5.Question

How does Ankita feel about Abhi's proposal for a secret court marriage, and what does this reveal about her character?

Answer: Ankita is taken aback and feels overwhelmed by Abhi's proposal for a secret marriage. This reaction demonstrates her ambition and her unwillingness to compromise her future for love, illuminating her inner conflict between desire and responsibility.

6.Question

What impact does Abhi's death have on Ankita, and how does it shape her views on love?

Answer: Abhi's death deeply traumatizes Ankita, filling her with regret for not expressing her feelings and leading to a profound understanding of love's fragility. It shapes her into

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a person who values love more sincerely and recognizes the significance of expressing emotions before it's too late.

7.Question

How does Ankita's perception of family and personal ambitions play a role in her relationship with Abhi?

Answer: Ankita's relationship with her family and her ambitions heavily influence her decisions regarding Abhi. She feels pressure to pursue her education and future in Bombay, which creates tension in her relationship, as she struggles to balance personal aspirations with emotional attachments.

8.Question

What does Abhi's grandfather say that impacts Ankita, and what does it symbolize?

Answer: Abhi's grandfather tells Ankita 'Never belittle love,' which symbolizes the profound understanding of love's significance, especially in moments of loss. This statement resonates with Ankita and becomes a guiding principle for her, influencing her interactions and perceptions of love

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moving forward.

9.Question

How does the chapter address themes of regret and communication in relationships?

Answer: The chapter illustrates the themes of regret and communication through Ankita's reflections on her unspoken feelings for Abhi and her missed opportunities to be honest. It emphasizes the critical need for open communication to nurture relationships and avoid the pain of unresolved emotions.

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Chapter 10 | Racing ahead| Q&A

1.Question

How did the protagonist adjust to life in Bombay?

Answer:The protagonist felt at home in Bombay, embracing its diversity and energy. Despite challenges like commuting for over an hour each way for college, she quickly adapted, making new friends and feeling welcomed by her peers and professors. This adaptability was influenced by her positive attitude and the welcoming environment of Bombay.

2.Question

What significance did jogging have in the protagonist's life?

Answer:Jogging became a transformative activity for the protagonist, providing her with energy and a new perspective on life. It invigorated her mornings, helped her appreciate small details of life, and boosted her enthusiasm for studies, eventually leading her to discover a passion for physical

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activity and competitive running.

3.Question

How did the protagonist's academic approach change after starting college?

Answer:Upon entering college, the protagonist developed a new studying method that involved creating colorful notes, which made learning more engaging and effective for her.

This approach allowed her to retain information better, as she began to visualize the content, leading to a significant improvement in her academic performance.

4.Question

What does the protagonist's reaction to her exam results reveal about her personality?

Answer:Her reaction to scoring 98 out of 100, where she felt disappointed for losing two marks, showcases her perfectionist tendencies. Despite her significant achievement, she was not content and felt an overwhelming drive to excel further, which indicates both her ambition and the potential for future challenges.

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5.Question

What insights can be gained from the protagonist's interactions with her peers?

Answer:The protagonist's interactions, particularly with her classmates Joseph, Jigna, and Chaya, reflect her developing social skills and relationships. The envy directed at her group showcases gender dynamics within the class, while her exchanges reflect a desire for recognition and acceptance, highlighting the challenges and triumphs of navigating new friendships.

6.Question

In what ways does the protagonist's experience reflect the complexities of student life?

Answer:Her experiences illustrate the balancing act of social integration, academic pressure, and personal ambition that many students face. She navigates the excitement of college life while grappling with increasing demands on her time and energy, showcasing the intensity of student life, including moments of joy, stress, and self-discovery.

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7.Question

What does the phrase 'a series of events that had to be pieced together gradually like a jigsaw puzzle' suggest about change?

Answer: This phrase emphasizes that personal growth and change often occur slowly and incrementally, rather than abruptly. It suggests that the protagonist's development is complex and layered, with each experience contributing to her overall transformation, hinting at the unpredictable nature of life and individual journeys.

8.Question

How does the protagonist define success at this point in her life?

Answer: At this stage, the protagonist equates success with academic excellence and achievements in her newfound pursuits, such as jogging and studying. However, her fixation on perfection and her intense drive also suggests that she may overlook the importance of balance and personal well-being as she strives for these goals.

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Chapter 11 | Dancing in the dark| Q&A

1.Question

What does the author learn about self-confidence through the experience of performing on stage?

Answer:The author discovers that self-confidence can lead to unexpectedly positive outcomes. Despite initial apprehension, she ends up delivering a captivating performance that earns her adoration and applause from the audience. This experience highlights how stepping outside one's comfort zone can unlock hidden talents and boost self-esteem.

2.Question

How does the celebration atmosphere contribute to the protagonist's transformation?

Answer:The vibrant atmosphere of the cultural festival, with its glittering decor and infectious energy, plays a pivotal role in transforming the protagonist's mood from hesitant to exuberant. It encourages her to embrace fun, dance, and engage in spontaneous behavior, showcasing how an

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encouraging environment can inspire individuals to become more open and adventurous.

3.Question

What warning does the protagonist ignore that later causes concern among her friends?

Answer:The protagonist disregards her friends' concerns about her reckless behavior while under the influence of excitement. Climbing onto the parapet and exhibiting dangerous bravado signifies a loss of judgment, revealing that the highs of confidence can sometimes lead to reckless choices that endanger one's safety.

4.Question

What does the scene on the terrace reveal about the protagonist's state of mind?

Answer:The terrace scene illustrates the protagonist's feelings of invincibility and detachment from reality. Despite the thrilling experience, her behavior reflects a troubling sense of escapism and a lack of self-awareness, as she is oblivious to the risks she is taking. This moment serves as a

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wake-up call about her current mental state and the underlying issues she needs to confront.

5.Question

How does the protagonist's experience at the festival serve as a metaphor for self-discovery?

Answer:The festival experience symbolizes a pivotal moment of self-discovery for the protagonist. The juxtaposition of joy and reckless behavior portrays the complexities of finding oneself amidst societal pressures and personal expectations. It compels her to confront the dualities of confidence and risk, ultimately leading to crucial reflection on her actions and self-identity.

6.Question

What emotions does the protagonist grapple with after her wild night?

Answer:After her chaotic experience, the protagonist grapples with feelings of shame, confusion, and fear. She realizes that her behavior was out of character and questions her judgment. This internal struggle reveals her vulnerability,

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as she faces the unsettling realization of losing control over herself, prompting a deep reflection on her identity and the choices she makes.

7.Question

Why is the protagonist's bond with her friends significant in this chapter?

Answer: The bond between the protagonist and her friends is significant as it highlights the themes of support, concern, and the challenges of individual identity within a group.

Their worry during her reckless moments shows the importance of having a supportive network that looks out for one another, reminding her of the need for trust and accountability in relationships.

8.Question

How does the author use the contrast between the festive atmosphere and the protagonist's inner turmoil?

Answer: The author effectively contrasts the festive atmosphere, characterized by joy and excitement, with the protagonist's inner turmoil and feelings of loss of control.

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This juxtaposition emphasizes that external appearances can often mask deeper issues, illustrating the duality of human experiences where moments of joy are intertwined with underlying struggles.

Chapter 12 | The descent| Q&A

1.Question

What motivates Ankita to share her notes with the class after the test preparation?

Answer: Ankita feels a strong urge to share her innovative colour-coded study technique, believing it could help her classmates succeed just as it helped her. She thinks her discovery is valuable and could be an eye-opener for both her peers and the faculty.

2.Question

How does Ankita's perception change when she begins to appreciate her surroundings?

Answer: As Ankita looks at her garden, she experiences a profound sense of clarity and beauty, appreciating nature in a way she hadn't before. This newfound awareness signals a

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shift in her emotional state, highlighting how her academic pressures had previously blinded her to life's simple yet beautiful details.

3.Question

What emotional turmoil does Ankita face after painting the waterfall?

Answer: Ankita feels anger and sadness upon realizing the waterfall is man-made, symbolizing a disconnect with nature. This leads to a deep reflection on her feelings for Abhi, evoking loss and regret for not staying in touch, thereby stirring emotional longing that she hadn't allowed herself to feel.

4.Question

What does writing the letter to Suvi represent for Ankita?

Answer: Writing the heartfelt letter serves as an outlet for Ankita's grief and emotions regarding Abhi. It signifies a desperate attempt to process her feelings and communicate her experiences, even if later interpreted through a psychiatric lens. It ultimately leads to a deeper descent into

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her emotional struggles.

5.Question

What is the irony in Ankita's writing experience?

Answer: Ankita believes that writing about her emotions will offer solace and clarity, yet it ironically leads her into a downward spiral of distress. The act of pouring her heart into the letter, intended to express and relieve her pain, instead becomes a source of further turmoil, marking the beginning of her descent.

6.Question

How does Ankita's perception of Professor MM shift throughout the chapter?

Answer: Initially, Ankita views Professor MM with disdain, labeling him with mockery. However, through her preparation for the exam, she becomes empowered by the knowledge from MM's course, ultimately finding an unexpected sense of accomplishment and clarity.

7.Question

What can be learned from Ankita's decision to distribute her notes?

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Answer: Ankita's decision to share her notes illustrates the importance of collaboration and the joy of helping others, yet it also serves as a cautionary tale about the consequences of actions driven by impulsive, overwhelming emotions. It highlights the need to consider the potential repercussions of our desire to be recognized and validated.

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Chapter 13 | A stop gap relationship| Q&A

1.Question

What realization does the narrator have about her feelings towards Joseph?

Answer:The narrator acknowledges that she does not truly love Joseph, and her feelings are instead complicated by her grief over Abhi. She feels guilty for lying to Joseph and feels that her involvement with him is merely a distraction rather than a genuine connection.

2.Question

How does writing provide relief to the narrator after Abhi's death?

Answer:Writing becomes a therapeutic outlet for the narrator, allowing her to process her emotions and keep Abhi's memory alive. The act of writing helps her capture her thoughts and creativity, offering a sense of assurance amidst her turmoil.

3.Question

What internal struggle does the narrator face throughout

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this chapter?

Answer: The narrator grapples with her conflicting emotions of love, guilt, and longing. She feels caught between her memories of Abhi and her new relationship with Joseph, leading to feelings of self-loathing and confusion about her identity.

4.Question

How does the narrator's perception of love become distorted in this chapter?

Answer: Her experience of loss causes her to equate emotional intimacy with transactional relationships, comparing her situation to that of sex workers who exchange emotions for survival, revealing her feelings of worthlessness and the emptiness of her current relationships.

5.Question

What significance does the poem 'A stop gap relationship' hold in understanding the narrator's emotional state?

Answer: The poem encapsulates the narrator's feelings of disconnection and emptiness in her current relationship with

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Joseph. It illustrates her emotional turmoil, as she recognizes that her relationship lacks genuine meaning, highlighting her grief and turmoil over Abhi's death.

6.Question

What does the narrator's frantic energy and need for immediate action suggest about her mental state?

Answer: Her frantic energy indicates an inner unrest and possibly a coping mechanism to distract herself from her grief. The urgency suggests a desire to fill the void left by Abhi and to validate her existence through various activities, including writing and running.

7.Question

How does the narrator feel about her creativity and how is that affected by the psychiatrists' opinions?

Answer: Initially, the narrator feels a sense of pride and satisfaction in her creative expression through poetry.

However, the intervention of psychiatrists, who label her creativity as a symptom of a thought disorder, fills her with fear and guilt, leading her to suppress her artistic side.

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8.Question

Describe how the narrator's encounter with Joseph in the cab changes her emotional landscape. What does it symbolize?

Answer: The encounter symbolizes a complex blend of longing for Abhi and a desperate attempt to fill the void he left. The kiss represents both an act of affection and a deep-seated guilt, as she uses it to cope with her past while realizing that her heart still belongs to someone else.

9.Question

How does the chapter illustrate the theme of coping with loss?

Answer: The chapter shows the narrator's struggle to cope with the loss of Abhi by engaging in a 'stop gap' relationship with Joseph. It highlights her attempts to distract herself and find solace while revealing the inadequacy of temporary connections to heal her profound grief.

10.Question

What does the narrator's self-hatred reveal about her internal conflicts?

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Answer: Her self-hatred reveals her deep-seated guilt about moving on from Abhi and her entanglements with Joseph and Vaibhav. She feels unworthy of love and happiness, associating her perceived worthlessness with her inability to honor her true feelings for Abhi.

Chapter 14 | The day something died| Q&A

1.Question

What emotions does the protagonist experience after her parents discover the letter from Abhi?

Answer: She feels a mix of shock, fear, and sadness at being exposed, along with anger and deep shame.

Her parents' reaction invokes a sense of violation and helplessness, leading her to grapple with feelings of worthlessness as her self-esteem shatters.

2.Question

How does the chaotic state of the protagonist's room reflect her mental state?

Answer: The disordered environment parallels her racing thoughts and emotional turmoil. Just as her room resembles a

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disorganized mess, her mind is filled with chaotic emotions and unresolved feelings, indicating her struggle to cope with her internal conflicts.

3.Question

What is the significance of the letters being burned by her father?

Answer:The act of burning the letters symbolizes a forceful denial of her past and emotions, representing the stifling of her identity and a deep loss of connection to her feelings for Abhi. It also reflects her father's attempt to control her life, furthering her sense of isolation and grief.

4.Question

How does the protagonist cope with her feelings of loss after the letters are destroyed?

Answer:In her pain and desperation, she turns to self-harm as a way to bring forth a tangible pain that she can manage. This act becomes a means of asserting some control over her body when her emotions feel overwhelming, highlighting her struggle with mental health.

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5.Question

What does the protagonist mean when she feels that something inside her has died along with the letters?

Answer:She senses that a part of her identity, her hopes, or a relationship has been extinguished with the destruction of the letters. It signifies a loss of innocence and connection to her emotions, leaving a void that is profoundly unsettling and painful.

6.Question

In what ways does the protagonist's internal conflict reflect broader themes of societal expectations?

Answer:Her struggle with parental expectations about love, privacy, and personal identity underscores the tension between individual desires and societal norms, particularly in the context of family honor and traditional values. It highlights the difficulty of navigating personal authenticity within rigid cultural frameworks.

7.Question

What is the impact of the protagonist's silence during her confrontation with her parents?

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Answer: Her silence symbolizes her inability to express her feelings and assert her independence, further deepening her isolation. It reflects her internal struggle and disconnect from her own emotions, as she feels powerless to confront her parents or even articulate her truth.

8.Question

How does the protagonist's perspective on herself change throughout the chapter?

Answer: Initially, she grapples with feelings of shame and guilt, but after the letters are burned, she feels a profound emptiness. This shift showcases her transformation from a hopeful young woman in love to someone who feels defeated and lost, questioning her self-worth.

9.Question

What do the 'phantasmagorical creatures' in her mind represent at the beginning of the chapter?

Answer: The creatures symbolize her once-vibrant imagination and the escapism she sought in the chaos of her thoughts. They represent the beauty and color of her dreams

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prior to her emotional turmoil, contrasting sharply with the darkness and void she feels later.

10.Question

How does the chapter illustrate the conflict between personal feelings and familial duties?

Answer:The protagonist's internal battle exemplifies the challenges faced when one's desires clash with familial responsibilities and societal norms. Her parents' strict values create a suffocating environment that clashes with her need for emotional freedom and self-expression.

Chapter 15 | Deeper down the bottomless pit| Q&A

1.Question

What does the overwhelming fear represent in this chapter?

Answer:The overwhelming fear represents an emotional and mental struggle that is irrational yet consumes the narrator, indicating a deeper psychological issue that may be developing. It symbolizes the hidden battles often faced when

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transitioning life stages or dealing with intense pressures.

2.Question

How does the narrator's interaction with her parents reflect her emotional state?

Answer:The narrator's interaction with her parents shows a profound sense of helplessness and vulnerability. While her parents attempt to provide comfort and reassurance, she feels isolated in her experience and unable to communicate the depth of her fear, highlighting the disconnect between her internal turmoil and their understanding.

3.Question

What role does the physical setting play in the narrator's mental state?

Answer:The physical setting, such as the ordinary scenes of daily life outside her window, contrasts sharply with the narrator's intense inner chaos. This juxtaposition emphasizes how her personal realities can change dramatically despite a seemingly normal world around her, illustrating feelings of

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alienation and anxiety.

4.Question

How does the reaction of the parents contribute to the understanding of mental health in the narrative?

Answer:The parents' reactions show a lack of understanding regarding mental health issues, attributing the narrator's distress to normal fears or anxiety over school. This represents a common societal misconception about emotional struggles, which can often lead to further isolation for those experiencing mental illness.

5.Question

In what ways does the author use imagery to depict fear?

Answer:The author uses vivid imagery to describe the physical sensations associated with fear, such as a 'sinking feeling at the pit of my stomach' and the 'cold sweat.' These descriptions create a visceral understanding of what the narrator is experiencing, making readers empathize with her plight.

6.Question

What does the narrator hope to achieve by trying to

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rationalize her fear, and what does this indicate about her state of mind?

Answer:By attempting to rationalize her fear, the narrator hopes to regain control over her emotions and escape the panic that is overwhelming her. This indicates a desire for understanding and normalcy, as well as the ongoing struggle to articulate what feels unnameable and uncontrollable.

7.Question

What message can be drawn about the importance of emotional expression and support from loved ones?

Answer:The narrative underscores the importance of emotional expression and the need for supportive conversations with loved ones. It suggests that open dialogue about feelings can create understanding and foster healing, rather than letting fear and confusion fester in silence.

8.Question

How does the chapter hint at the challenges ahead for the narrator in dealing with her mental health?

Answer:The chapter hints at forthcoming challenges by

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describing an acute sense of fear that escalates without clear reason, suggesting the potential onset of more severe mental health struggles, such as depression or anxiety disorders. This foreshadows a critical turning point in the narrator's journey.

9.Question

What coping mechanism does the narrator initially resort to when she feels panic and fear?

Answer:The narrator initially resorts to deep breathing and attempts to rock back and forth to calm herself. These physical actions reflect a natural instinct to seek self-soothing techniques when overwhelmed, although they prove to be only temporarily effective.

10.Question

How does the author's portrayal of the narrator's mindset contribute to the overall theme of mental health awareness?

Answer:The author's portrayal of the narrator's mindset illustrates the complexities and intricacies of mental health experiences, encouraging readers to recognize the

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seriousness of such feelings. By depicting the struggle in a relatable manner, it contributes to the overall theme of raising awareness about the necessity for empathy, understanding, and open discussions about mental health.

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Chapter 16 | The ink blots| Q&A

1.Question

What do you do when you're overwhelmed by feelings of depression and can't communicate your struggles to others?

Answer:It can be incredibly difficult to articulate feelings of depression, especially when it feels like everyone has high expectations of you. It's important to acknowledge your feelings and consider reaching out for help, even if it feels daunting. Speaking to a mental health professional, like a psychiatrist or therapist, can provide a safe space to express what you're going through without fear of judgment.

2.Question

How do you cope with feelings of worthlessness and hopelessness?

Answer:Acknowledging that these feelings exist is the first step. It's crucial to understand that feelings of worthlessness are often not true reflections of reality. Engaging in small,

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manageable activities that you once enjoyed can help. This could include writing, drawing, or even just going for a short walk. Seeking support from friends or family can also provide comfort and perspective.

3.Question

What should you do if your mental health worsens despite your efforts to feel better?

Answer:If your mental health is deteriorating, it's vital to seek professional help immediately. Don't hesitate to let someone close to you know about your struggles, as they can support you in finding and accessing the help you need—such as therapy, medication, or other resources.

4.Question

What coping strategies can individuals who feel mentally stuck implement?

Answer:When feeling mentally stuck, try implementing structured routines, setting small daily goals, and engaging in self-care activities like exercise, meditation, or journaling. Breaking tasks into manageable parts can make them feel

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less overwhelming and more achievable.

5.Question

How can someone express their struggles to family members who have high expectations of them?

Answer:It might be helpful to have an open and honest conversation with your family about your feelings. You can frame it by expressing your gratitude for their support, but also sharing that you're facing challenges that are affecting your wellbeing. It's important to communicate how their expectations impact you emotionally.

6.Question

In a moment of frustration or despair, what are some healthier outlets than self-harm?

Answer:Instead of resorting to self-harm, consider healthier alternatives like talking to someone you trust, writing down your feelings, practicing deep breathing or mindfulness, hitting the gym, or engaging in a creative hobby. Finding non-destructive outlets can help in processing intense emotions.

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7.Question

When is it necessary to seek professional help for mental health issues?

Answer:It's time to seek professional help if feelings of sadness, anxiety, or hopelessness persist over a long period, interfere with your daily life, or lead to thoughts of self-harm or suicide. Professional guidance can provide the necessary tools and support to navigate these challenges effectively.

8.Question

How can one find the courage to seek help when feeling ashamed or afraid?

Answer:Understanding that many people experience similar feelings can help reduce shame and fear. Remind yourself that seeking help is a sign of strength, not weakness.

Connecting with support groups or mental health communities can provide a sense of solidarity and encouragement.

9.Question

What role do family and friends play in recovery from mental health struggles?

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Answer: Family and friends can provide crucial support and understanding during recovery. They can help by listening, encouraging open communication, and assisting with seeking professional help or accompanying you to appointments. Their involvement can remind you that you are not alone in your journey.

10.Question

How important is it to accept help from others during difficult times?

Answer: Accepting help from others is vital during tough times. It allows you to share the burden of your struggles, fosters connections, and can significantly lessen feelings of isolation or hopelessness. Remember, everyone needs support at various times in their lives.

Chapter 17 | The light goes out| Q&A

1.Question

What does Ankita wish for that reflects her emotional struggle?

Answer: Ankita aches to feel something—pain, grief,

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or even just the ability to think. She longs for her lost creativity and the ability to express herself through poetry and art, which had previously been an integral part of her identity.

2.Question

How does Ankita feel about her medication and its effects on her?

Answer: Ankita feels trapped by her medication, which makes her drowsy and numb. While her parents believe it will help her, she experiences a debilitating blankness and feels as though her ability to think and create has been stripped away.

3.Question

What does Ankita's reflection in the mirror symbolize in her journey?

Answer: Her reflection symbolizes how far she has fallen from her former self. She does not recognize the physical manifestation of her mental anguish, which includes weight gain and a neglected appearance, highlighting her internal

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struggle.

4.Question

What leads Ankita to a breaking point in her struggle?

Answer: Ankita reaches her breaking point when she sees no improvement in her condition despite her parents' belief in the medication. Feeling misunderstood and trapped, she contemplates taking her own life as an escape from her relentless suffering.

5.Question

How does Ankita's behavior change in response to her frustration?

Answer: In a fit of rage, Ankita destroys items in her room, including throwing her books and shattering her pen holder. This outburst reveals her intense frustration and the societal stigma around expressing such emotions, particularly for women.

6.Question

What is the significance of Ankita's desire for darkness?

Answer: Ankita develops an affinity for darkness as it mirrors her mental state—she feels at peace in the absence of light

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and noise, reflecting her inner turmoil and her desire to escape from the pain of consciousness.

7.Question

How does Ankita perceive her interaction with Dr. Mukta?

Answer:Ankita feels vulnerable and frightened during her interaction with Dr. Mukta. Instead of finding comfort, she feels like a subject of an experiment, heightening her sense of helplessness regarding her treatment.

8.Question

How does Ankita's perception of time contribute to her sense of despair?

Answer:Ankita's perception of time is distorted; she is unable to distinguish between day and night, which contributes to her feelings of isolation and hopelessness, as the days blur into one another in her darkened room.

9.Question

What does Anne's story reveal about the challenges of mental health treatment?

Answer:Ankita's story highlights the complexities of mental

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health treatment. It shows the disconnect between patient experience and external perceptions, illustrating the difficulty of navigating medication's side effects and the emotional struggles that accompany mental illness.

10.Question

What role do Ankita's parents play in her experience?

Answer: Ankita's parents are well-meaning but ultimately unaware of the depth of her suffering. Their insistence on medication as a cure becomes a source of frustration for Ankita, who feels they do not understand her pain.

Chapter 18 | A plan for a final exit| Q&A

1.Question

What led the narrator to contemplate suicide for the second time?

Answer: The narrator experienced a relentless period of hopelessness and agony, worsened by ineffective medication from a psychiatrist who showed no genuine concern for their well-being. The overwhelming sense of despair and feeling like a

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burden to their parents compounded the struggles they faced.

2.Question

How did the narrator describe their feelings towards their own existence?

Answer:The narrator felt their existence was completely pointless, battling feelings of being a burden to their parents and being unable to do anything useful or meaningful. They felt disconnected from themselves and others, leading to a profound sense of worthlessness.

3.Question

What role did the narrator's parents play in their struggle with mental health during this time?

Answer:The narrator's parents showed unwavering support and love, insisting on taking them to various psychiatrists and ensuring they followed prescribed medication, despite the narrator's silence and withdrawal. Their belief in the narrator's potential for recovery contrasted starkly with the narrator's feelings of despair.

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4.Question

What moment ultimately changed the narrator's mind about taking their life?

Answer:The intervention of the narrator's father, who arrived just in time while the narrator was on the edge of the terrace contemplating suicide, shocked the narrator. The sight of their father's tears and helplessness had a profound impact, leading the narrator to reconsider their intentions.

5.Question

What does the father's reaction reveal about the impact of mental health struggles on families?

Answer:The father's reaction, characterized by tears and helplessness, illustrates the deep emotional toll that mental health struggles can have on family members. It highlights the silent suffering experienced by loved ones when someone is in distress, reflecting that mental health challenges extend beyond the individual and affect the entire family unit.

6.Question

What is the significance of the narrator's final apology to their father?

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Answer: The narrator's apology encapsulates a mix of regret, recognition of the pain inflicted on their loved ones, and a desperate desire for understanding. It signifies a pivotal moment of vulnerability and connection, acknowledging the burden of their struggles on their father.

7.Question

How does the narrator's reflection on their previous happy memories contribute to their state during the crisis?

Answer: Nostalgia for happier days, such as their previous experiences enjoying life, starkly contrasts with their current despair. This reflection emphasizes their feelings of loss, reinforcing the chasm between who they used to be and who they had become, deepening their sense of isolation and hopelessness.

8.Question

What lessons can be drawn from the narrator's experience regarding mental health and seeking help?

Answer: The narrative underscores the importance of compassion in mental health care, the need for effective

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communication, and the critical role of family support. It also highlights that recognizing the value of life and the love of those around us can be a powerful motivator for seeking help and finding hope.

9.Question

What message does this chapter convey about the resilience in the face of mental health struggles?

Answer: The chapter conveys that even in the depths of despair, moments of connection and profound love from family can reignite the will to fight through pain. It emphasizes that there is hope, and that reaching out for help can lead to recovery, regardless of how hopeless the situation may seem.

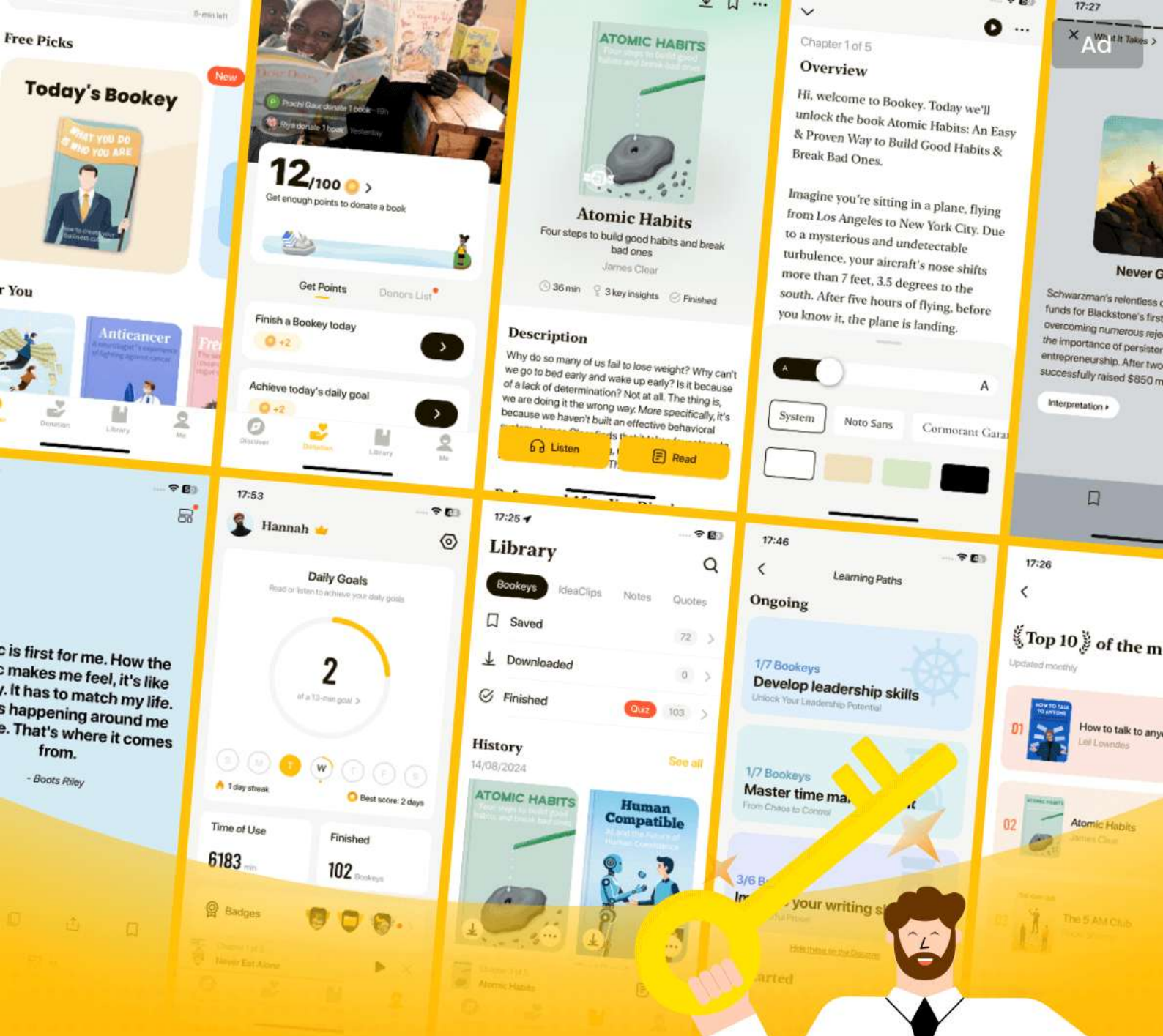
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Chapter 19 | No way out| Q&A

1.Question

What is the significance of feeling trapped in the psychiatrist's office?

Answer:Feeling trapped symbolizes the overwhelming nature of mental illness and the journey one takes towards seeking help. It reflects a struggle not only against internal demons but also against the societal stigma surrounding mental health issues.

2.Question

How does the protagonist's reaction to being admitted to the hospital reflect her mental state?

Answer:Her feelings of rage, helplessness, and panic convey the depth of her mental suffering. This reaction illustrates how mental illness can distort one's self-perception, leading to feelings of unworthiness and abandonment.

3.Question

What does the interaction with Dr. Madhusudan reveal about the importance of communication in mental health

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treatment?

Answer:Dr. Madhusudan's clear explanation of bipolar disorder offers a sense of relief and understanding. This interaction highlights that effective communication can help patients grasp their condition, reduce fear, and foster a sense of control over their health.

4.Question

How does the concept of ECT challenge the stigma associated with mental health treatments?

Answer:Dr. Madhusudan's reassurance about ECT presents it as a legitimate medical intervention rather than the frightening portrayal often seen in media. This emphasizes the importance of education in combating stigma and encouraging acceptance of mental health care.

5.Question

What role do family dynamics play in the protagonist's emotional turmoil?

Answer:The protagonist's feelings of abandonment by her parents intensify her emotional struggles. This dynamic

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illustrates the critical nature of support from loved ones during times of crisis and how their decisions can affect one's mental health.

6.Question

Can you identify a turning point in the protagonist's acceptance of her situation?

Answer:The moment Dr. Madhusudan explains her illness and assures her that it's treatable marks a key turning point. It shifts her perspective from one of hopelessness to recognizing that she is not alone in her struggles and that recovery is possible.

7.Question

What does the author suggest about the journey to recovery from mental illness?

Answer:The author suggests that recovery is neither instant nor easy; it requires cooperation with caregivers, acceptance of one's condition, and navigating the often cyclical nature of mental health struggles. Collaboration and seeking help are crucial components of healing.

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8.Question

How does the environment of the hospital contribute to the protagonist's feelings of despair?

Answer:The cold, clinical setting of the hospital serves as a physical manifestation of her emotional state—isolating and intimidating, it reinforces her feelings of being trapped and highlights her internal chaos.

9.Question

What can readers learn from the protagonist's experience about dealing with mental health issues?

Answer:Readers can learn the importance of seeking help, understanding that mental health issues are valid medical conditions, and recognizing that vulnerability does not equate to weakness. Open discussions about mental health are vital for healing.

10.Question

How does the initial silence of the protagonist after receiving ECT reflect her state of mind?

Answer:Her silence signals confusion and possibly a temporary reprieve from her emotional turmoil, indicating

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that while her symptoms are alleviated for the moment, the underlying struggle still persists.

Chapter 20 | A tiny ray of hope| Q&A

1.Question

What does the narrator learn about the power of kindness and communication during her time in the hospital?

Answer:The narrator realizes that kindness and communication can have a profound healing effect, sometimes even more than medication. Dr. Madhusudan's comforting presence and understanding words instill a sense of hope and reassurance, highlighting that emotional support is essential for recovery.

2.Question

How does the environment of the hospital room impact the narrator's mental state?

Answer:Initially, the stark and empty room reflects the narrator's feelings of emptiness and despair. However, she finds solace in the cocoon-like environment, which allows

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her the space to reflect and begin to feel safe, ultimately aiding her recovery.

3.Question

What significance does Dr. Madhusudan's personal story hold for Ankita?

Answer:Dr. Madhusudan's personal experience of losing his sister to suicide resonates deeply with Ankita. It not only fosters a bond between them but also serves as a poignant reminder of the value of life and the importance of seeking help, encouraging her to see hope beyond her current struggles.

4.Question

What shift occurs in Ankita's perspective about her life and future as a result of Dr. Madhusudan's guidance?

Answer:Under Dr. Madhusudan's care, Ankita slowly begins to entertain the possibility that there are alternatives to her current path of pursuing her MBA. This shift marks the first time she considers her future in a hopeful light, suggesting that her worth is not tied to one specific outcome.

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5.Question

What role does routine play in Ankita's recovery journey?

Answer:The structured routine provided in the Occupational Therapy wing offers Ankita a sense of stability and purpose after a period of aimlessness. It helps her to engage with daily activities, rekindling her interests and fostering a sense of normalcy that contributes positively to her mental health.

6.Question

How does art become a therapeutic outlet for Ankita?

Answer:Upon encountering the art supplies in the recreation room, Ankita is reminded of her past joy in painting. This moment signifies a turning point, as she begins to re-engage with her passions, illustrating how creative expression can serve as a powerful tool for healing and self-discovery.

7.Question

What insights does Ankita gain about mental health through her interactions with others in the O.T wing?

Answer:Ankita observes that the other patients, despite their struggles, exhibit a spectrum of normality and humanity.

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This revelation helps to reduce her feelings of isolation and stigma, emphasizing that mental health issues can affect anyone, further normalizing her own experiences.

8.Question

What does Ankita ultimately discover about life and hope during her hospital stay?

Answer: Ankita learns that life, despite its challenges and the darkness she has faced, holds the potential for renewal and hope. Through her experiences and the support she receives, she begins to see that healing is possible and that the future can offer joy and fulfillment.

Chapter 21 | Faith is a powerful thing| Q&A

1.Question

What moment helped Ankita realize her own progress and normalcy in her life?

Answer: Ankita felt a significant realization when she compared herself to Sagar and Anuj, recognizing that she appeared just like anyone else to those around her. This epiphany made her

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understand that she was, in fact, 'normal', as she decided to mask her emotions and portray herself positively to others.

2.Question

How did Ankita's experience with painting connect to her emotional state?

Answer:Painting served as a therapeutic outlet for Ankita, allowing her to express herself creatively for the first time in months. Her frenzied and passionate painting reflected her newfound engagement with life and helped shift her focus from despair to feeling alive and vibrant.

3.Question

What role did Dr. Madhusudan play in Ankita's healing process?

Answer:Dr. Madhusudan provided Ankita with reassurance and guidance. His understanding of her condition, coupled with his validation of her talent in writing and painting, became a crucial support system for her recovery. His presence gave her faith that she could manage her battle with

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bipolar disorder.

4.Question

How did the conversations with Sagar and Anuj impact Ankita's social anxiety?

Answer:The conversations were significant in helping Ankita ease her social anxiety. She felt comfortable engaging with Sagar and Anuj without them probing into her past, leading her to feel secure and more at ease in expressing herself after a long period of isolation.

5.Question

What does the analogy of Vincent Van Gogh symbolize for Ankita?

Answer:Vincent Van Gogh's life story symbolized for Ankita that many talented individuals have experienced similar emotional struggles. It gave her a sense of identification with her own condition, showing her that creativity and pain often coexist, and she could harness her experiences to create something meaningful.

6.Question

What does Ankita's transition to participating in sports

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imply about her recovery?

Answer: Ankita's decision to participate in sports signifies an important step in her recovery. It showcases her willingness to engage in physical activity, which contributed positively to her mental state and overall well-being, emphasizing that recovery involves both physical and emotional dimensions.

7.Question

What did Dr. Madhusudan mean when he said that creativity is associated with bipolar disorder?

Answer: Dr. Madhusudan explained that individuals with bipolar disorder often experience heightened emotions that can lead to deep creativity. This condition, while challenging, can enable them to express their feelings through art or writing, similar to famous figures like Vincent Van Gogh.

8.Question

What is the significance of trust in Ankita's relationship with her doctors?

Answer: Ankita's trust in Dr. Madhusudan's support is pivotal to her healing process. It reflects her need for a reliable

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anchor during her turbulent emotional journey. This trust serves as a foundation for her faith in the treatment and empowers her to confront her challenges head-on.

9.Question

How does the environment within the rehab center contribute to Ankita's feelings of normalcy?

Answer:The rehabilitation center's environment facilitated a sense of community and normalcy for Ankita, as she interacted with others who faced their struggles without judgment. This atmosphere allowed her to feel accepted and validated, which was essential for her emotional recovery.

10.Question

What does Ankita learn about vulnerability through her therapy sessions?

Answer:Ankita learns that vulnerability, though uncomfortable, can also be liberating. By being open about her experiences and feelings, especially through her interactions with Dr. Madhusudan and her peers, she begins to dismantle the barriers she built around herself, finding

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strength in her honesty.

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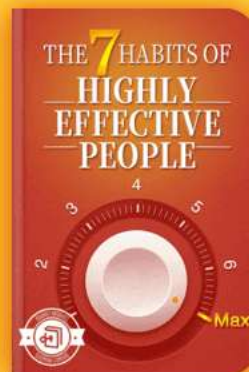
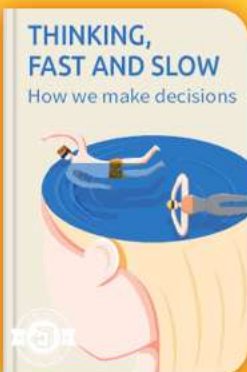


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Chapter 22 | One step at a time| Q&A

1.Question

What can we learn about the importance of small steps in the process of recovery as illustrated by Dr.

Madhusudan's note to Ankita?

Answer:Dr. Madhusudan's note, 'One step at a time, Ankita. We're getting there!' emphasizes that recovery is a gradual process and that taking small steps can lead to significant progress. It suggests that instead of being overwhelmed by the enormity of the challenge, focusing on small, manageable tasks can help in rebuilding confidence and abilities.

2.Question

How did Ankita's feelings about her reading ability reflect her journey of self-acceptance?

Answer:Initially, Ankita felt frustrated and defeated by her inability to read and retain simple sentences, leading her to doubt herself and her intellect. However, as she slowly began to regain her abilities through Dr. Namita's supportive approach and her own persistence, she experienced immense

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joy and a sense of accomplishment, ultimately leading her towards self-acceptance and the realization that progress takes time.

3.Question

What role did the books play in Ankita's emotional healing and cognitive recovery?

Answer:The children's books served as a bridge for Ankita's emotional healing and cognitive recovery by providing her with a safe space to explore reading again. They were not just books but a symbol of hope and a reminder of her childhood innocence. Reading them helped her reconnect with her love for literature, which was a core part of her identity, ultimately aiding her in reclaiming her intellect and enhancing her cognitive functions.

4.Question

What does Ankita's relationship with Anuj and Sagar reveal about the importance of support systems during recovery?

Answer:Ankita's relationship with Anuj and Sagar highlights the vital role support systems play in recovery. Their

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friendship provided her with emotional comfort, understanding, and encouragement. Their ability to share their own struggles without diminishing hers helped her feel less isolated and more 'okay' with her journey, thereby fostering a sense of community and belonging that is crucial during challenging times.

5.Question

How does the chapter illustrate the theme of resilience in the face of adversity?

Answer: The chapter illustrates resilience through Ankita's determined effort to confront her cognitive challenges after a significant emotional and mental trauma. Despite her frustrations and setbacks, she continues to try and eventually experiences small victories. Her persistence in reaching out for help and embracing the support available to her demonstrates her resilient spirit in navigating the complexities of her recovery.

6.Question

What significance does the phrase 'Life is a celebration' have in the context of this chapter?

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Answer: The phrase 'Life is a celebration' signifies the importance of acknowledging small joys and moments of connection, even amidst struggles. It underscores the idea that despite the challenges faced, life has its beautiful moments that deserve to be celebrated—a philosophy embodied by Anuj and Sagar through their thoughtful gift to Ankita, reinforcing a positive outlook.

7.Question

How did Ankita's experience with the children's books empower her to overcome her challenges?

Answer: Ankita's experience with the children's books empowered her by easing her back into the world of reading without the pressure associated with adult literature. The simplicity and charm of the children's stories allowed her to regain her reading skills gradually and built her confidence, showing her that it's possible to start afresh and make significant progress, even from a seemingly low point.

Chapter 23 | I am the master of my fate| Q&A

1.Question

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What is the significance of Dr. Madhusudan's statement about Ankita's writing and painting talent?

Answer: Dr. Madhusudan's encouragement for Ankita to pursue her writing and painting talent underscores the importance of recognizing and utilizing one's gifts. It signifies that despite her struggles, she possesses unique abilities that can contribute positively to her life and others'. This realization becomes a catalyst for Ankita to value her creativity more than her previous ambitions.

2.Question

How did Ankita's perspective on life change after her experience?

Answer: Ankita's ordeal led to a paradigm shift in her view of life. Initially focused solely on her MBA and corporate success, she realized that true happiness lies in valuing relationships, creativity, and personal fulfillment. She started appreciating life's gifts and understood that pursuing one's passions, like writing, is far more meaningful than following

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societal expectations.

3.Question

What does Ankita's decision to drop out of her MBA program symbolize?

Answer: Ankita's decision to drop out symbolizes her liberation from societal pressures and her embrace of authenticity. It reflects her newfound understanding that success isn't defined by conventional standards, but rather by personal satisfaction and joy. It marks her transition towards a path that aligns with her true self.

4.Question

What does the letter to Vaibhav reveal about Ankita's growth and transformation?

Answer: The letter to Vaibhav reveals Ankita's profound growth; she expresses her journey from despair to clarity and purpose. It showcases her ability to reflect on her experiences and articulate her feelings, highlighting her resilience and the wisdom she gained. The letter encapsulates her appreciation for life and her commitment to pursue what truly makes her

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happy.

5.Question

How does the ending of the chapter reflect Ankita's outlook on life after her recovery?

Answer: The ending of the chapter reflects Ankita's joyful rebirth; she celebrates small moments like the blooming flowers and rain, symbolizing her appreciation for life. This joy signifies her healing and her intent to cherish each moment going forward, indicative of a person who has emerged from adversity with a renewed zest for life.

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Life is What You Make It Quiz and Test

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Chapter 1 | A new world| Quiz and Test

1. Ankita attends IIT-D in Delhi for her college education.
2. Ankita feels a mix of excitement and anxiety about starting college.
3. The college Ankita attends is co-educational, similar to her previous school.

Chapter 2 | Nothings gonna stop us now| Quiz and Test

1. The protagonist has a close-knit circle of five friends in college.
2. Vaibhav plays a love song during his phone call with the narrator on her 18th birthday.
3. The chapter highlights the absence of female students in the college setting.

Chapter 3 | Election Selection| Quiz and Test

1. Ankita is nominated for the Arts Club Secretary

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role by her friend Suvi.

2. Ankita's main rival in the election is a senior student.

3. Ankita and her fellow office bearers feel pressure and excitement as they prepare for the festival 'Symphony.'

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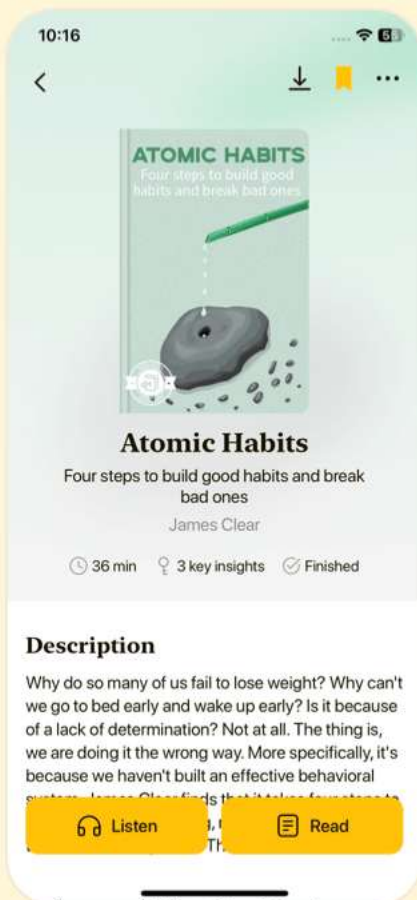


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Chapter 4 | Girl on a Motorcycle| Quiz and Test

1. Ankita begins to enjoy the motorcycle ride despite initially feeling anxious and guilty.
2. Abhi confesses his feelings for Ankita after they have been friends for several years.
3. Ankita decides to ignore Abhi's letter after receiving a call from her friend Suvi.

Chapter 5 | Life is what you make it| Quiz and Test

1. Ankita feels completely comfortable and at ease without any nervousness during her visit to Abhi's home.
2. Abhi shares details about his troubled past, including an abusive relationship with his father.
3. The chapter emphasizes a one-dimensional view of love and relationships, with no complexities involved.

Chapter 6 | The needle swings| Quiz and Test

1. Ankita believes she has lost her virginity after visiting Abhi's house.
2. Suvi encourages Ankita to be open about her feelings and

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explore her emotions.

3. Ankita's feelings for Vaibhav remain unchanged throughout the chapter.

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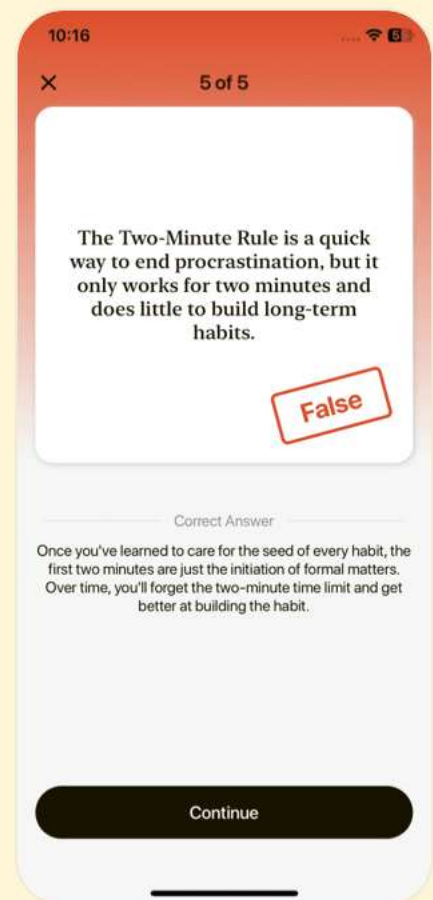
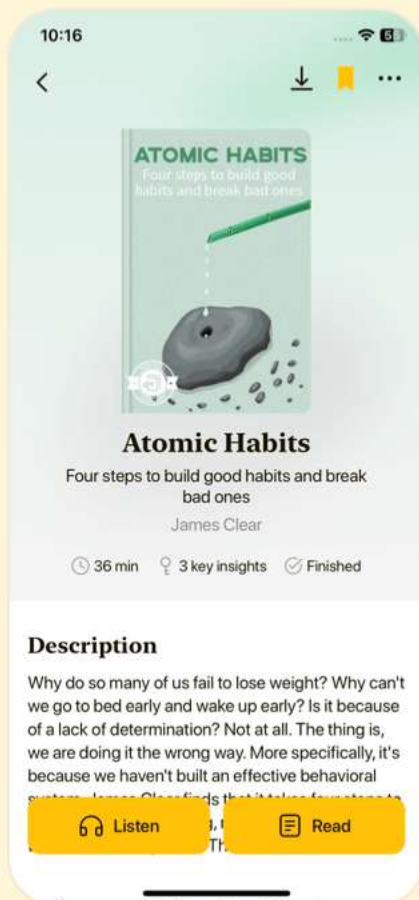


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Chapter 7 | Destiny changes in moments| Quiz and Test

1. Ankita shares her first kiss with Abhi during the Mahatma Gandhi University Youth Festival.
2. Sanjana and Suja face no consequences for their involvement in the scandal.
3. The college authorities support the girls despite their mistakes during the youth festival.

Chapter 8 | Ready to fly| Quiz and Test

1. Ankita decides to contest in the elections again during her final year graduation.
2. Ankita and Abhi have a close bond as she prepares for her MBA entrance exams.
3. Abhi is supportive of Ankita's ambitions and does not feel left out as she receives multiple interview calls.

Chapter 9 | Never Belittle Love| Quiz and Test

1. Ankita moves to Bombay to pursue a prestigious MBA program while her brother is accepted into a U.S. university.

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2. Ankita and Abhi communicated regularly after their initial fight and there were no unresolved issues between them.
3. The chapter emphasizes the importance of cherishing love and communication after a tragic event.

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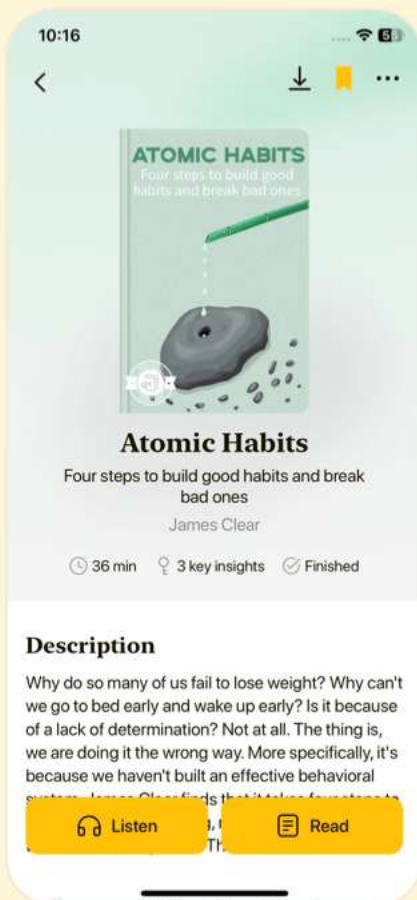


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Chapter 10 | Racing ahead| Quiz and Test

- 1.The protagonist in Chapter 10 quickly adapts to her new life as a college student in Bombay.
- 2.The protagonist manages to maintain a perfect score throughout her time at the management institute.
- 3.The chapter portrays a sense of ease and a lack of pressure in the protagonist's academic journey.

Chapter 11 | Dancing in the dark| Quiz and Test

- 1.Ankita participates in a competitive event at the cultural festival.
- 2.During the festival, Ankita delivers a comedic performance that impresses the audience.
- 3.Ankita feels completely confident and in control of her actions throughout the night.

Chapter 12 | The descent| Quiz and Test

- 1.Ankita develops a unique color-coded note-taking technique to prepare for her marketing management test.
- 2.Ankita's friend Joseph encourages her to continue her



impulsive behavior without concern for potential backlash from professors.

3. After the test, Ankita feels a mix of relief and joy, ultimately leading to the completion of her letter reflecting on her past with Abhi.

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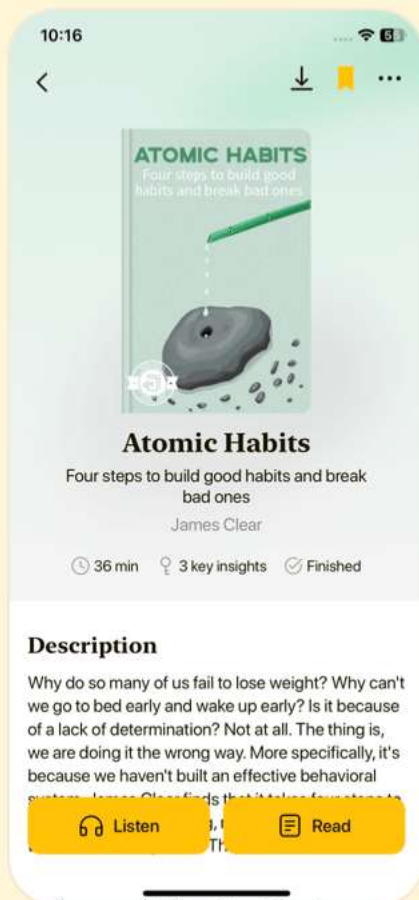


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Chapter 13 | A stop gap relationship| Quiz and Test

- 1.The protagonist feels guilty after kissing Joseph because she realizes it was an attempt to fill the void left by Abhi.
- 2.The protagonist confides in Vaibhav about her past love Abhi, feeling that it would help her heal.
- 3.The chapter centers around the protagonist's struggles with her creative expression being viewed as a symptom of mental disturbance by psychiatrists.

Chapter 14 | The day something died| Quiz and Test

- 1.The protagonist feels emotionally overwhelmed due to her parents' lack of understanding and harsh reactions.
- 2.The protagonist's father burns letters that signify her past connections to Abhi, which does not affect her emotionally.
- 3.The chapter ends with the protagonist feeling a sense of fulfillment and hope for the future.

Chapter 15 | Deeper down the bottomless pit| Quiz and Test

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1. Ankita's fear in Chapter 15 is linked to her new MBA program.
2. The chapter illustrates themes of anxiety and isolation associated with mental health.
3. Ankita's parents fully understand her feelings of dread and know how to help her.

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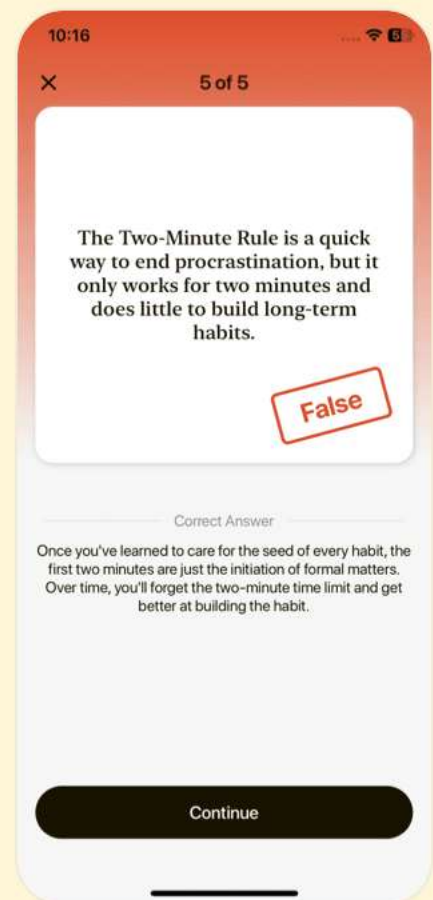
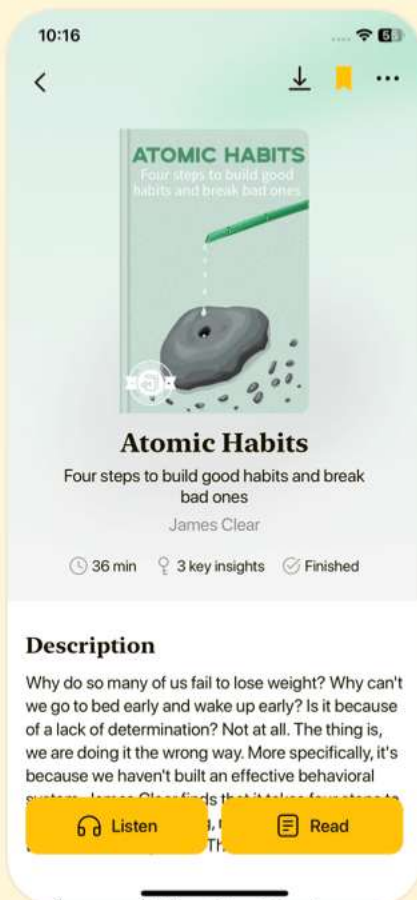


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Chapter 16 | The ink blots| Quiz and Test

1. Ankita successfully adapts to her new life in Bombay without any mental health struggles.
2. Ankita's parents are unaware of her mental health issues until she attempts self-harm.
3. The psychiatrist diagnoses Ankita with mild anxiety after conducting psychological tests.

Chapter 17 | The light goes out| Quiz and Test

1. Ankita feels relief from the medication prescribed by Dr. Mukta.
2. Ankita isolates herself and prefers to stay in her dark room during her struggles.
3. The chapter emphasizes that Ankita's parents fully understand her internal struggles and emotions.

Chapter 18 | A plan for a final exit| Quiz and Test

1. The protagonist visits a renowned psychiatrist, Dr. Kohli, who effectively addresses her feelings and concerns.
2. The protagonist considers various methods of suicide but

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ultimately decides to follow through with jumping off her building's terrace.

3. Her father's presence and emotions do not affect the protagonist's feelings about her own struggles.

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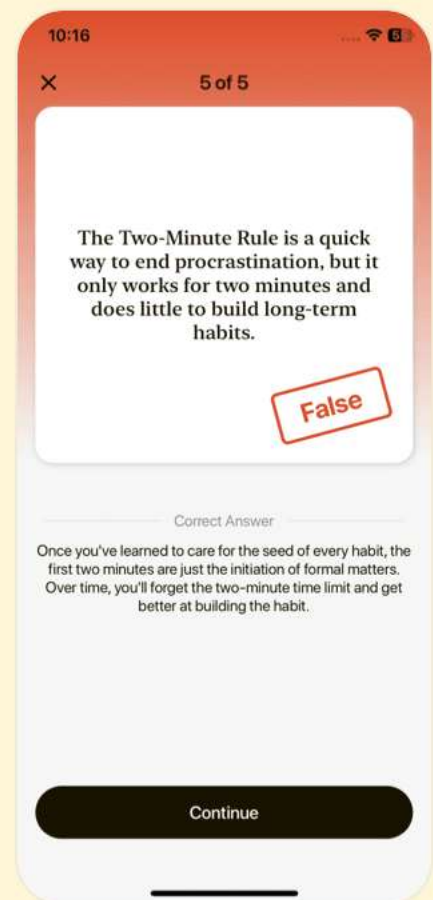
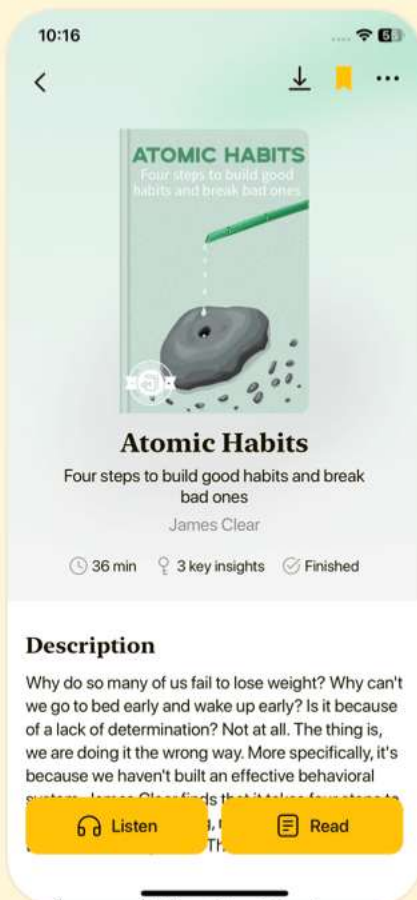


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Chapter 19 | No way out| Quiz and Test

1. Ankita feels a sense of betrayal and anger towards her parents when they decide for her to be admitted for observation at a mental health facility.
2. Dr. Madhusudan's discussion with Ankita after her breakdown reveals that she does not have any health issues related to her mental struggles.
3. The chapter emphasizes the importance of empathy and support during moments of despair for individuals struggling with mental health issues.

Chapter 20 | A tiny ray of hope| Quiz and Test

1. Ankita feels trapped but also safe in her private room.
2. Dr. Madhusudan prescribes her an antidepressant, which he believes is essential for her condition.
3. The Occupational Therapy wing resembles a hospital environment and does not support Ankita's recovery.

Chapter 21 | Faith is a powerful thing| Quiz and Test

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1. Ankita finds solace in painting and feels empowered by her creativity.
2. Ankita prefers to share her troubled past with Sagar and Anuj during their first meeting.
3. Dr. Madhusudan is a junior doctor who makes Ankita uncomfortable with his probing questions.

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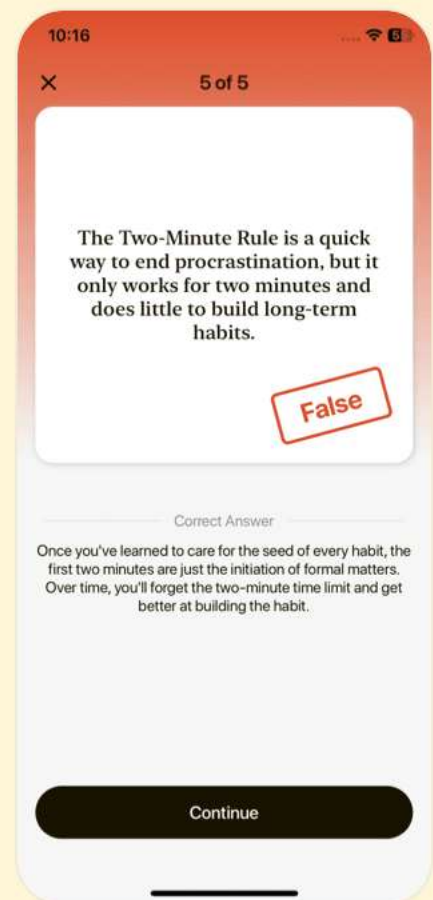
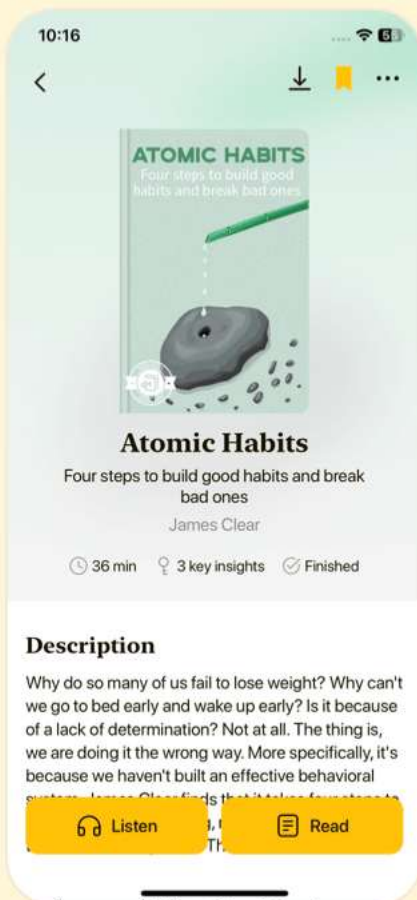


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Chapter 22 | One step at a time| Quiz and Test

1. Ankita receives a gift of children's books from Dr. Madhusudan that belonged to his childhood.
2. Ankita struggles with reading and comprehension but gives up on her therapy sessions.
3. The theme of solidarity among patients is emphasized through Ankita's new friends Anuj and Sagar.

Chapter 23 | I am the master of my fate| Quiz and Test

1. Ankita decides to pursue her MBA program after leaving the mental health facility.
2. Dr. Madhusudan encourages Ankita to continue her medication as part of her recovery process.
3. Ankita's letter to Vaibhav signifies her reluctance to share her experiences after her transformation.

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